SYDE 671 · ASSIGNMENT 2 · FALL 2026

Spatial Filtering and Multiresolution Blending

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Experiments in convolution, image gradients, sharpening, hybrid images, and multiresolution blending. Each section presents the method, visual results, and observations.

Contents

1. **Part One · Filters**
    1. Convolutions from scratch
    2. Finite differences and thresholding
    3. Derivatives of Gaussians
    4. Gradient orientations
2. **Part Two · Frequencies**
    1. Image sharpening
    2. Hybrid images
    3. Gaussian and Laplacian stacks
    4. Multiresolution blending

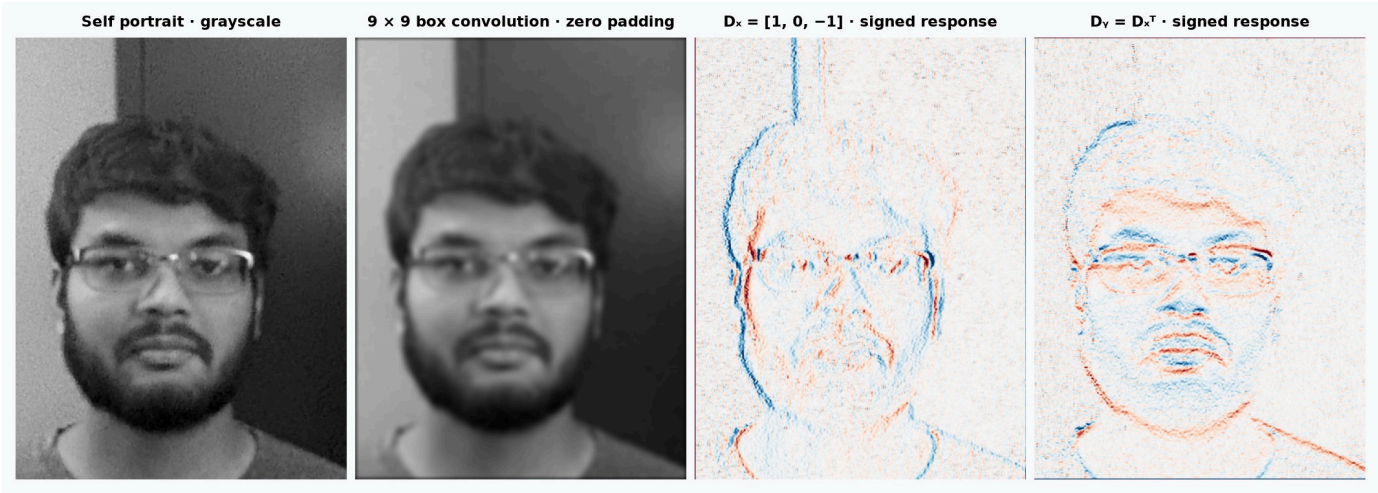
Implementation appendix · Reproduction · Image credits

Online report: https://mokshtrehan.github.io/syde671-assignment2/

1.1 Convolutions from scratch

Convolution flips a kernel in both dimensions, then sums the products of overlapping samples. I implemented this operation using four loops and two loops, and applied a box filter and two derivative filters to the self portrait.

Filters $B = (1/81) \cdot \mathbf{1}_{9\times9}$ $D_x = [1, 0, -1]$ $D_y = D_x^T$



Self portrait, box-filtered image, and signed horizontal and vertical derivatives. Red indicates positive responses and blue indicates negative responses. The shared derivative scale clips the strongest responses for display.

Filtering the portrait

The box filter removes fine texture. The horizontal and vertical derivatives emphasize intensity changes across columns and rows. Their signed responses share a symmetric color scale. Zero padding darkens the outer rim of the smoothed image and can introduce derivative responses at the frame.

The working image is 384 × 512 pixels. Grayscale intensity is 0.299R + 0.587G + 0.114B, with RGB values in [0, 1].

Implementation

The four-loop version iterates over image rows, image columns, kernel rows, and kernel columns. The two-loop version retains the kernel loops and multiplies complete shifted image slices. Both use NumPy operations only; neither calls a convolution, FFT, window-view, or image-processing routine.

Appendices A and B contain the input checks, padding, and both complete implementations.

1.1 Runtime and boundary effects

Maximum absolute error is the largest pixelwise difference from SciPy; runtime is the median elapsed time per call. Both implementations agree to floating-point precision. Asymmetric odd and even kernels test reversal and alignment, which a symmetric Gaussian alone cannot reveal.

Runtime and numerical agreement · 96 × 96 float64 input

Kernel	Method	Median time (ms)	Max. absolute error
3×5 asymmetric	Four loops	43.908	5.55e-16
3×5 asymmetric	Two loops	0.123	5.55e-16
3×5 asymmetric	SciPy convolve2d	0.209	0.00e+00
2×4 asymmetric (even)	Four loops	23.082	8.88e-16
2×4 asymmetric (even)	Two loops	0.08	8.88e-16
2×4 asymmetric (even)	SciPy convolve2d	0.138	0.00e+00
9×9 box	Four loops	209.111	7.77e-16
9×9 box	Two loops	0.609	7.77e-16
9×9 box	SciPy convolve2d	0.9	0.00e+00
1×3 derivative	Four loops	9.022	0.00e+00
1×3 derivative	Two loops	0.047	0.00e+00
1×3 derivative	SciPy convolve2d	0.095	0.00e+00

Both manual methods require O(HWKhKw) arithmetic. The two-loop version removes Python's per-pixel loop overhead by operating on image slices. These timings are local measurements, using a 96 × 96 float64 image and the median of three calls after one warm-up.

What happens at the image boundary?

Boundary values for a constant image

SciPy boundary setting	Corner	Top edge midpoint	Center
fill	0.308642	0.555556	1.0
symm	1.0	1.0	1.0
wrap	1.0	1.0	1.0

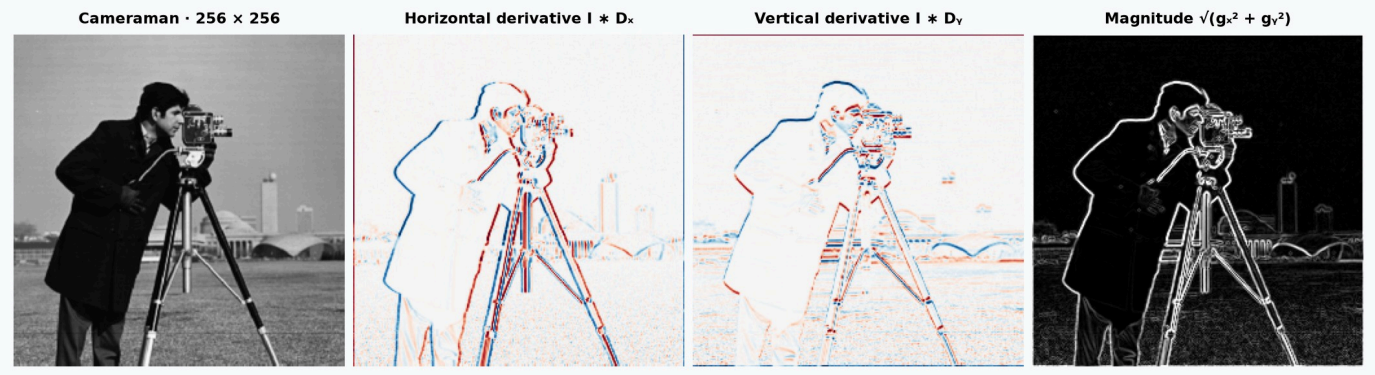
For a constant 25 × 25 image and a normalized 9 × 9 box filter, zero padding gives 25/81 at a corner and 5/9 at an edge midpoint. Symmetric and periodic extension preserve one. The "same" option sets output size; the boundary option supplies samples outside the image.

Along each axis, the manual implementations pad by floor(K/2) before the image and floor((K–1)/2) after it. This matches SciPy's "same" convention for even kernels. The largest comparison error is 8.88×10^{-16}.

1.2 Finite difference operator

The cameraman image is differentiated horizontally and vertically. Gradient magnitude combines these signed responses into an unsigned measure of edge strength.

Gradient $g_x = I * D_x \quad g_y = I * D_y \quad |\nabla I| = \sqrt{(g_x^2 + g_y^2)}$



Cameraman finite differences and gradient magnitude. Signed derivatives share the range [−0.65, 0.65]; magnitude uses [0, 0.65].

Interpreting the derivatives

The horizontal response emphasizes intensity changes across columns; the vertical response emphasizes changes across rows. Convolution reverses the derivative kernel, so an increase from left to right produces a positive horizontal response.

The white border is cropped from the supplied cameraman image before resizing it to 256 × 256 pixels. Computation uses floating-point intensities in [0, 1]. The complete crop coordinates and preprocessing steps are recorded in Appendix B.

1.2 Choosing an edge threshold

A pixel is classified as an edge when its gradient magnitude exceeds T. Three thresholds show the balance between retaining weak contours and rejecting background texture.



Threshold comparison for the finite-difference magnitude. The selected threshold is 0.16. The black outer frame is excluded from evaluation.

Threshold sensitivity

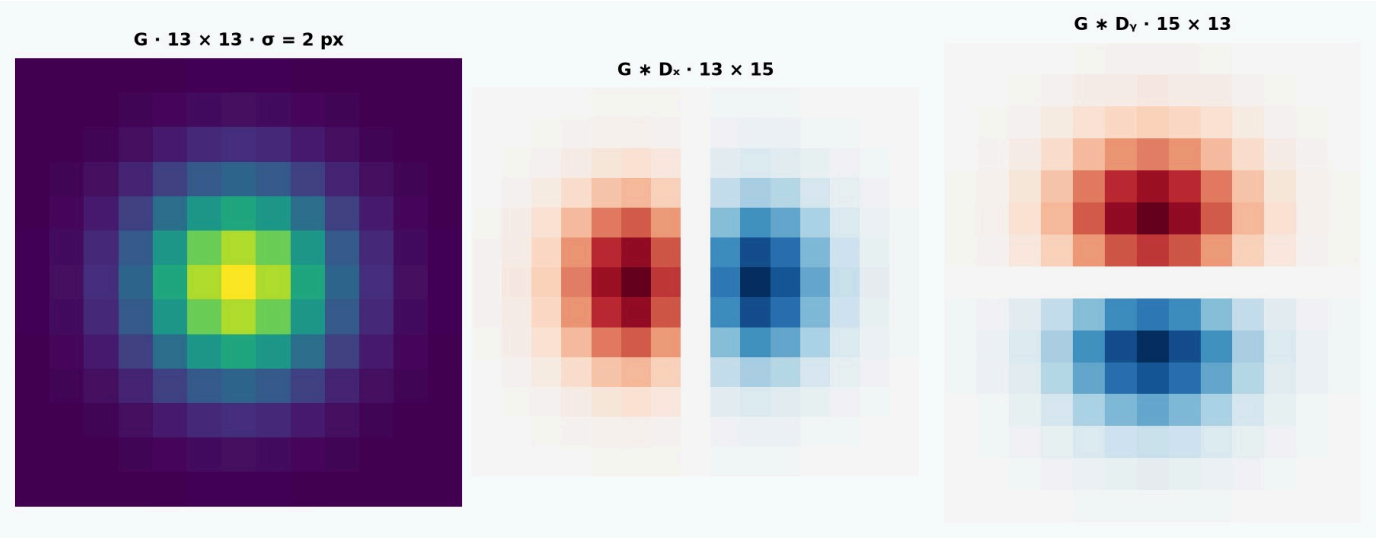
Threshold	Interior edge fraction	Selection
0.08	23.68%	Comparison
0.16	12.81%	Selected
0.24	8.99%	Comparison

A threshold of 0.16 preserves the person, camera, and tripod while rejecting much of the ground texture visible at 0.08. Raising it to 0.24 removes more weak contours. This selection is based on the images; no annotated edge map is used to measure detection accuracy.

A seven-pixel frame is excluded from all Part 1 binary maps and edge-fraction measurements. This removes responses caused by zero padding and covers the largest Gaussian-derivative support. The signed derivative and magnitude images show the complete responses.

1.3 Derivative of Gaussian

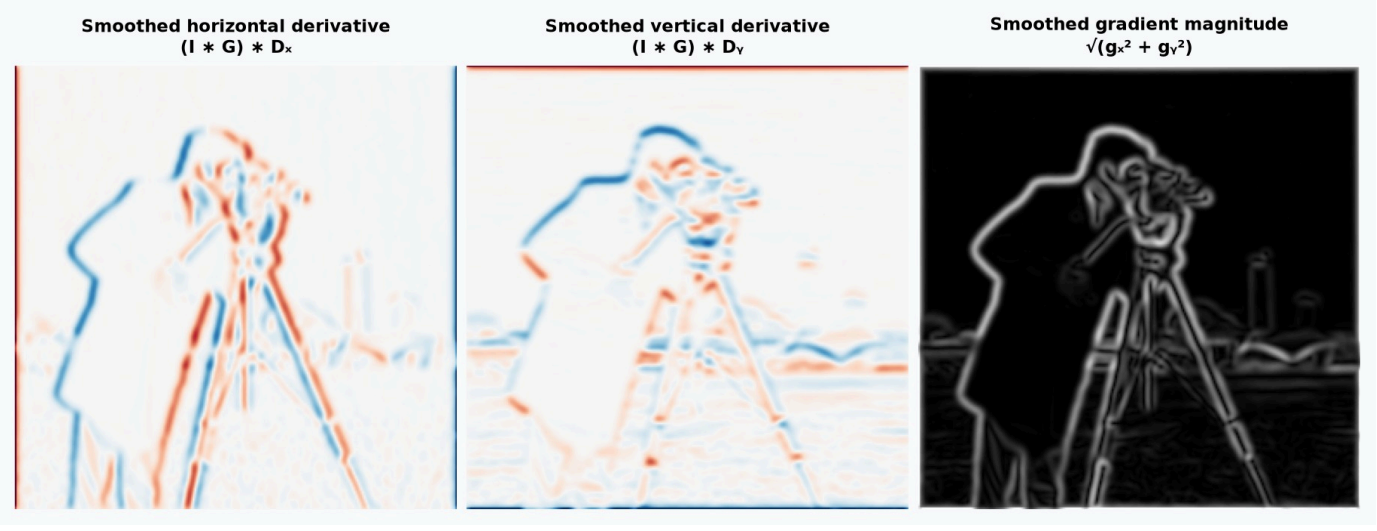
Smoothing before differentiation reduces the response to fine texture. A 13 × 13 Gaussian with σ = 2 pixels is formed from the outer product of cv2.getGaussianKernel(13, 2) with itself.



Gaussian kernel and its sampled horizontal and vertical derivatives. The derivative kernels share a signed scale; the Gaussian uses a separate nonnegative scale.

Convolving this Gaussian with the finite-difference kernels gives a single filter for each derivative. Full kernel convolution produces supports of 13 × 15 and 15 × 13 pixels.

Combined filters $K_x = G * D_x \quad K_y = G * D_y$



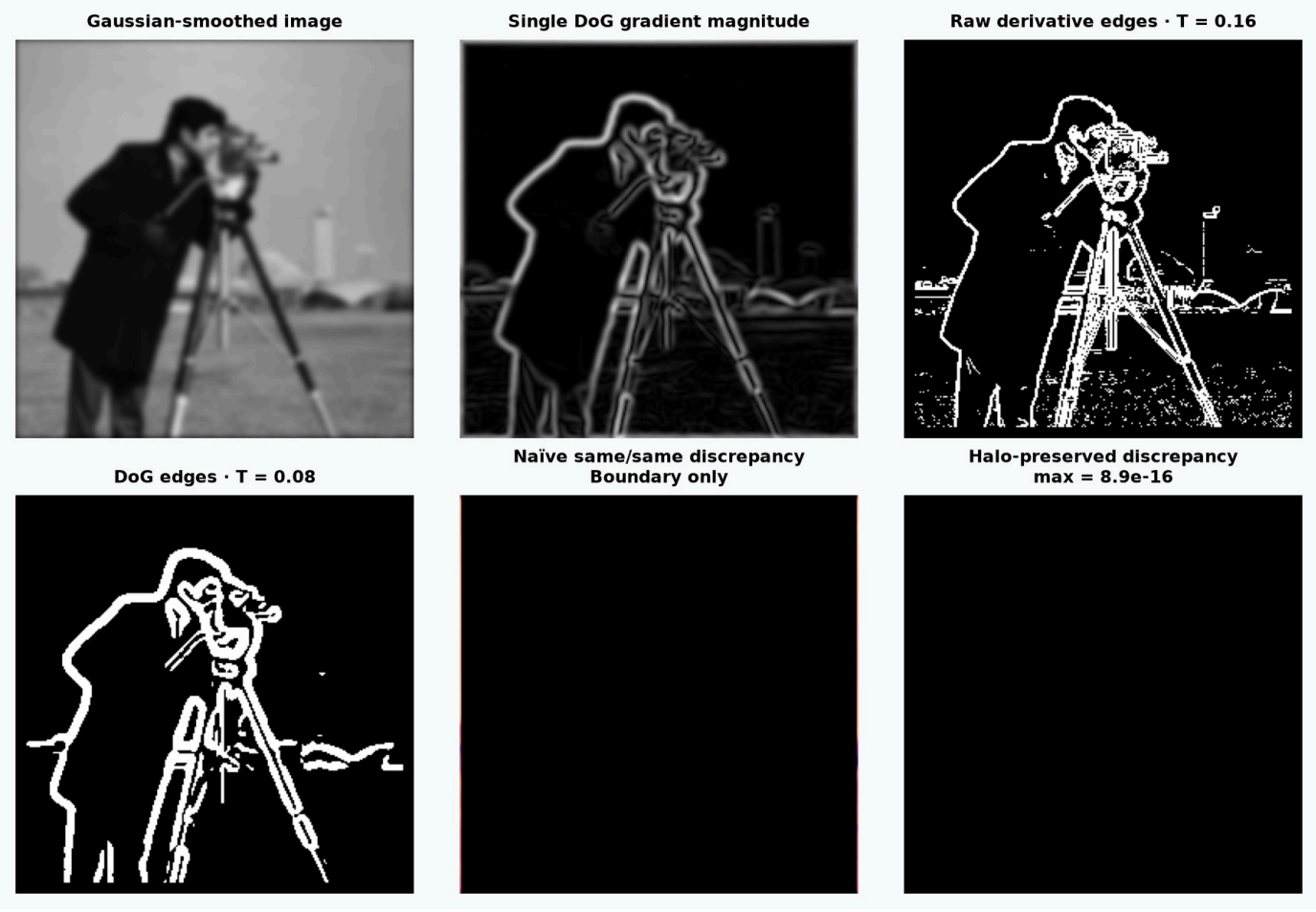
Finite differences after Gaussian smoothing, using two successive “same” convolutions with zero padding. Signed derivatives share [−0.35, 0.35]; magnitude uses [0, 0.35].

Compared with the unsmoothed derivatives, the contours are wider and the grass texture is weaker. Nearby edges can merge, and weak detail can disappear.

1.3 Sequential and combined filtering

Sequential and combined filtering should agree when both use the same boundary treatment.

Associativity $I * (G * D) = (I * G) * D$



Gaussian derivative results, thresholded edges, and boundary differences. Keeping the full intermediate blur restores agreement.

Agreement between the two formulations

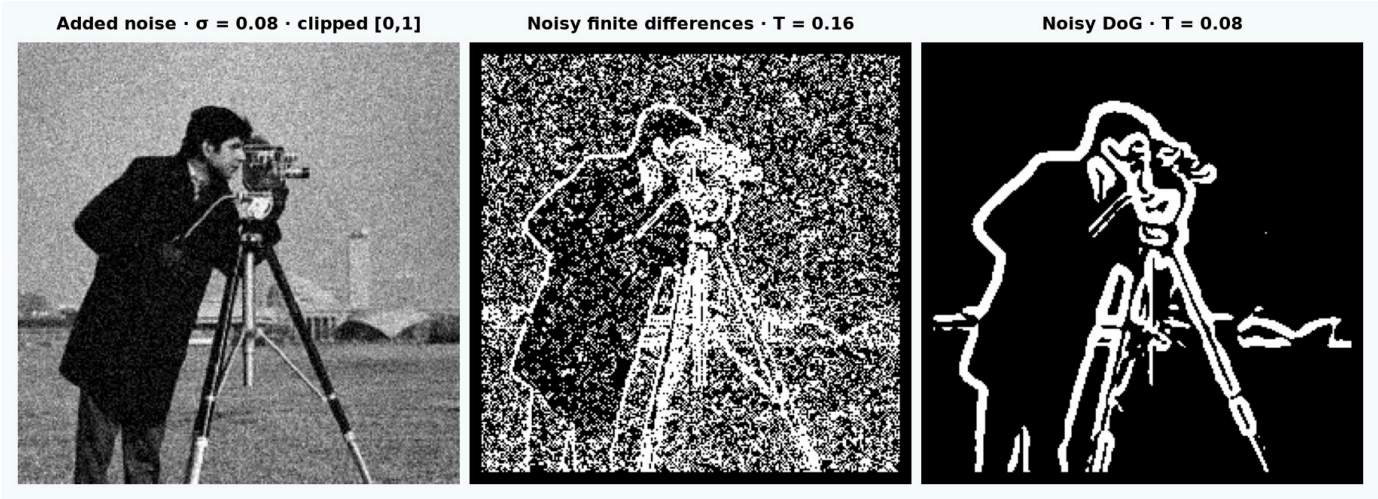
Measurement	Value
Two successive “same” convolutions vs. DoG · maximum error	0.307441
Two successive “same” convolutions vs. DoG · interior maximum error	8.95e-16
Full intermediate image vs. DoG · maximum error	8.95e-16

Two successive “same” convolutions crop the intermediate blur before differentiation. This removes samples outside the original frame and creates the boundary differences above. Keeping the full intermediate image and cropping once restores agreement across the complete output.

The edge maps use T = 0.08 for the Gaussian derivative and T = 0.16 for the original finite differences. Smoothing reduces response amplitudes, so these are separately selected visual settings, not a comparison of measured detection accuracy.

1.3 Sensitivity to added noise

Gaussian noise with σ = 0.08 is added using a fixed random seed, and the resulting intensities are clipped to [0, 1]. Each noisy gradient is compared with the same method applied to the clean image.



Cameraman image with added Gaussian noise and the resulting edge maps. Gaussian smoothing suppresses many of the noise responses visible with finite differences.

Noise residual $\text{RMS} = \sqrt{\text{mean}[(g_{x,\text{noisy}} - g_{x,\text{clean}})^2 + (g_{y,\text{noisy}} - g_{y,\text{clean}})^2]}$

Interior vector-gradient residual

Measurement	Value
Finite-difference gradient residual RMS	0.152265
DoG gradient residual RMS	0.010304

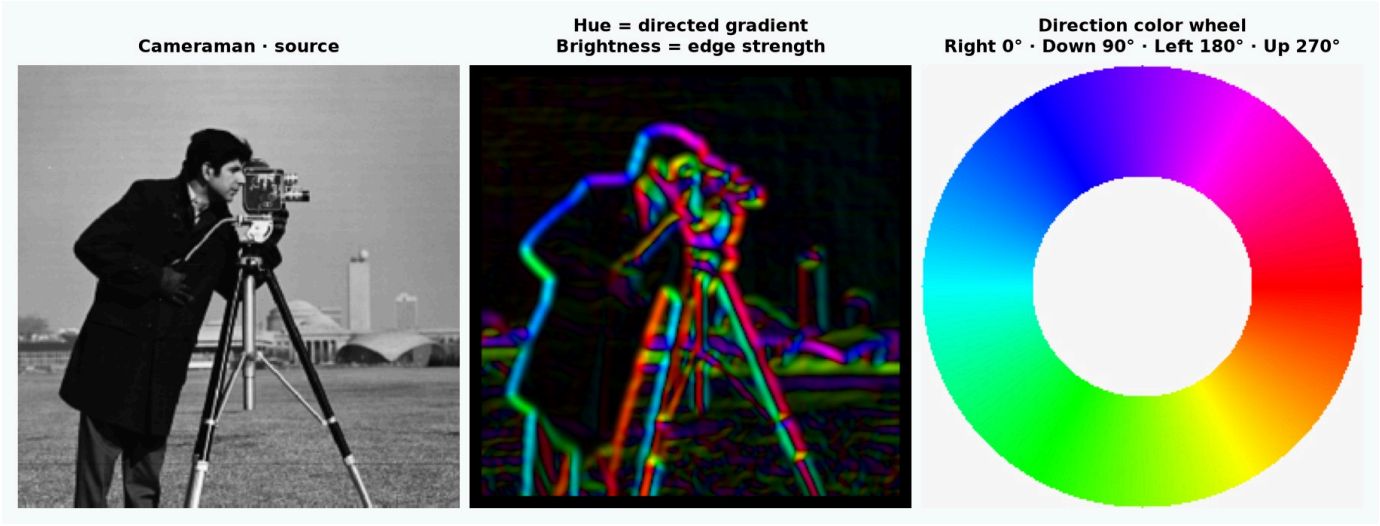
Effect of smoothing

The residual RMS decreases from 0.15226 for finite differences to 0.01030 for the derivative of Gaussian, a factor of 14.8. Smoothing suppresses many isolated noise responses, leaving a more continuous outline of the person and camera.

This test measures sensitivity to the added noise in this image. It does not measure recovery of detail lost through smoothing.

1.4 Gradient orientations

The Gaussian-derivative responses also define the direction of increasing intensity. Hue shows this direction, while brightness shows gradient strength.



Gradient orientation and direction color wheel. Hue represents direction in image coordinates; brightness represents edge strength. The seven-pixel boundary margin is excluded.

Reading the orientation map

The gradient is perpendicular to an edge tangent. Image rows increase downward, so 90° points down. Weak responses are dark, and the excluded seven-pixel boundary is black.

HSV mapping

$$h = (\theta \bmod 2\pi)/(2\pi) \quad s = 1$$
$$v = \min(|\nabla I| / 0.2386, 1)^{0.7}$$

The brightness reference, 0.2386, is the 99.5th percentile of interior gradient magnitude.

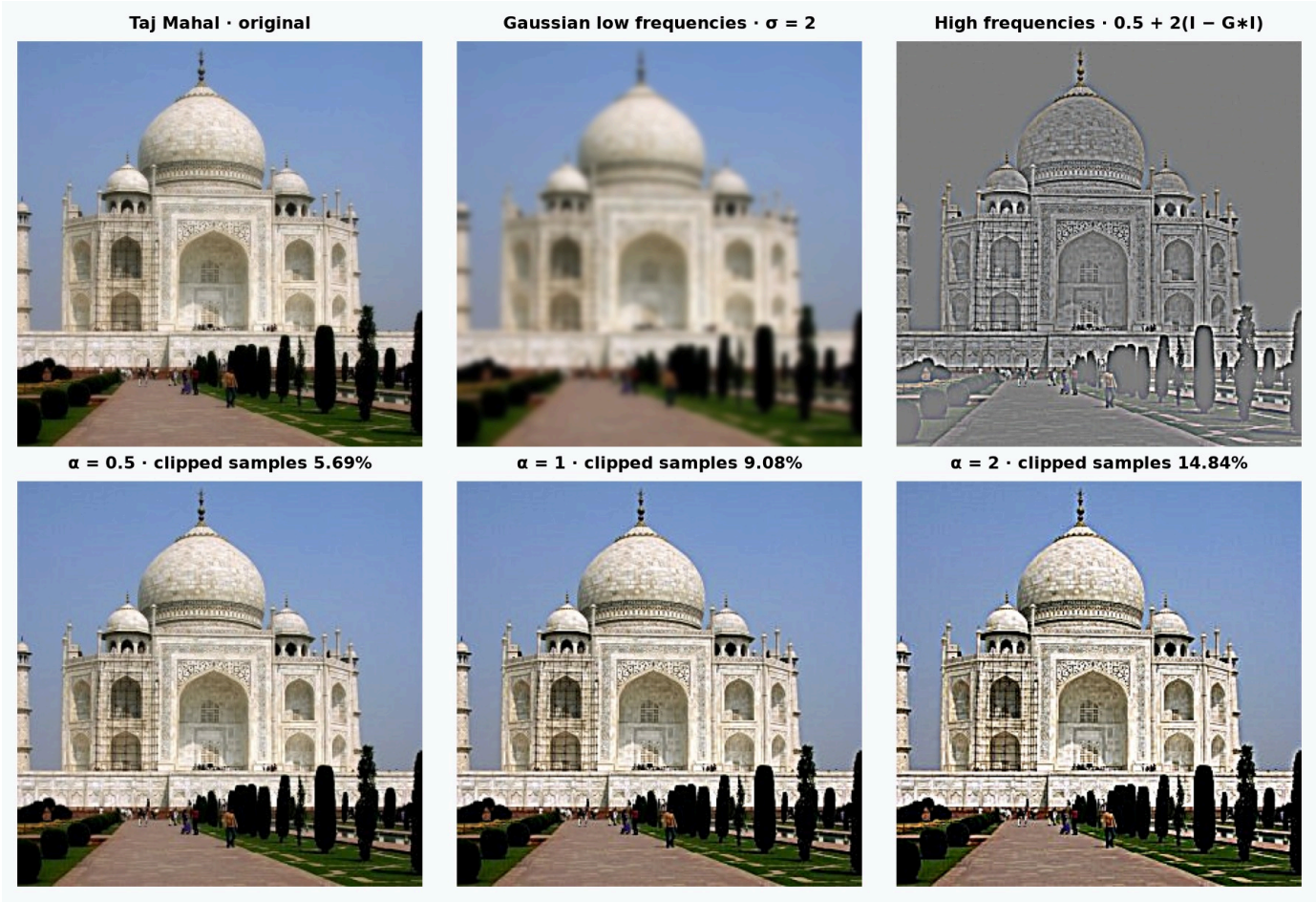
Computing the angle

The implementation uses an 18-term arithmetic series with range reduction and quadrant correction. It does not call arctangent, atan2, or an angle routine. Comparison with NumPy atan2, used only for validation, gives a maximum error of 4.44×10^{-16} radians. Appendix C gives the derivation and complete implementation.

2.1 Image sharpening

Unsharp masking adds a scaled high-frequency residual to the original image. The Gaussian blur supplies the low-frequency component; subtracting it from the input isolates detail.

Unsharp mask $B = G * I \quad H = I - B \quad S = I + \alpha H$



Taj Mahal: original image, Gaussian blur, high-frequency residual, and sharpening at α = 0.5, 1, and 2. The residual is displayed as 0.5 + 2H. Final display values are clipped to [0, 1].

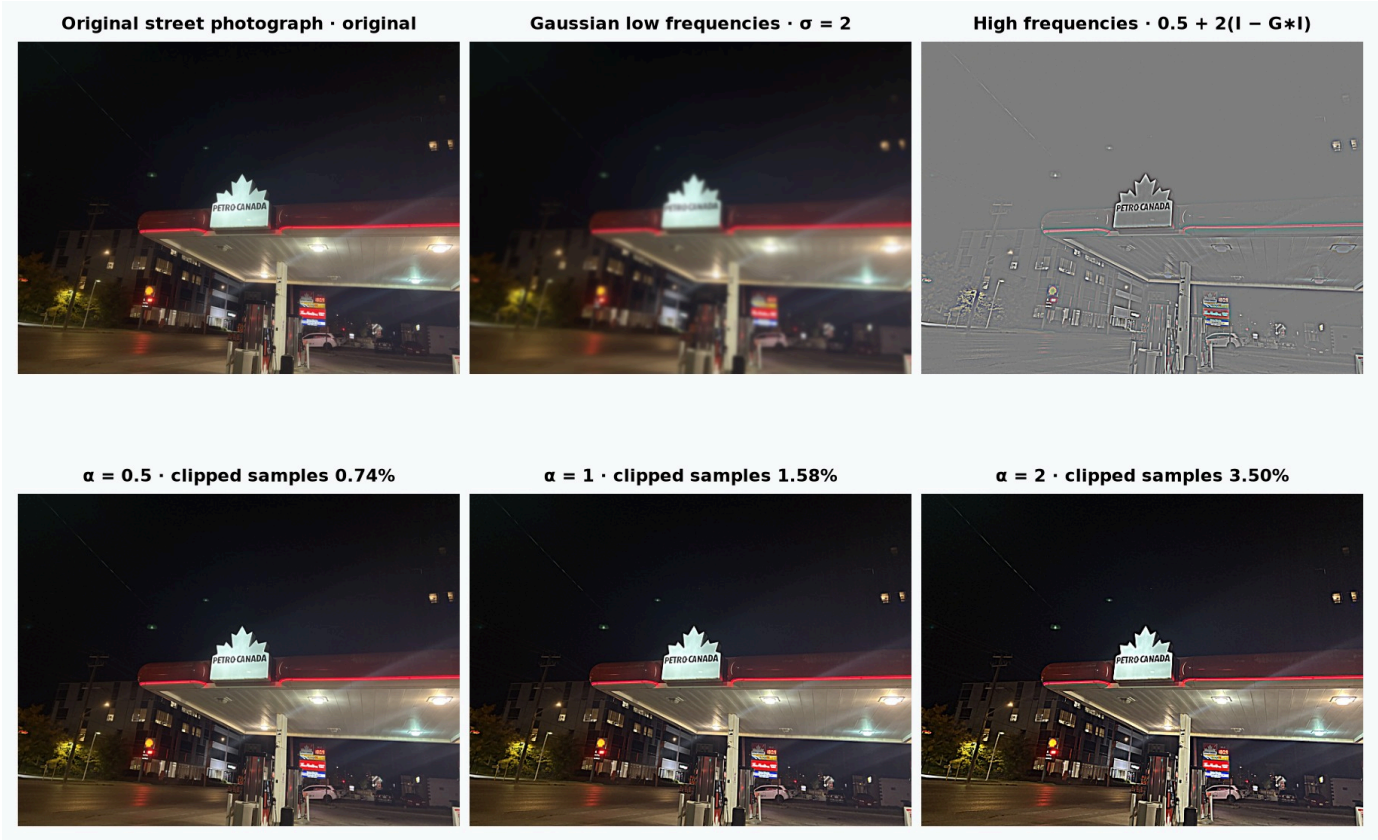
Effect of the sharpening amount

Increasing α strengthens the Taj Mahal's edges and texture. At the largest setting, halos and clipped highlights also become more apparent. Sharpening increases local contrast but can amplify noise and existing artifacts.

Both sharpening examples use a 13 × 13 Gaussian with σ = 2 pixels and symmetric boundaries. RGB channels are processed independently in float64. Residuals use the fixed display mapping 0.5 + 2H, so middle gray means zero.

2.1 Sharpening the street photograph

The same filter and sharpening amounts are applied to the original street photograph. Fine building edges and road texture become more distinct as α increases.



Original street photograph: original image, Gaussian blur, high-frequency residual, and sharpening at α = 0.5, 1, and 2. The residual is displayed as 0.5 + 2H. Final display values are clipped to [0, 1].

RGB values outside the display range

Image	α	Values outside [0, 1]
Taj Mahal	0.5	5.687%
Taj Mahal	1.0	9.075%
Taj Mahal	2.0	14.845%
Original street photograph	0.5	0.741%
Original street photograph	1.0	1.581%
Original street photograph	2.0	3.504%

The table counts scalar RGB values outside [0, 1] before export. The Taj Mahal image clips more heavily than the street image at every tested setting. Signed residuals and out-of-range values are retained during computation; only display exports are clipped.

2.1 One convolution and its limits

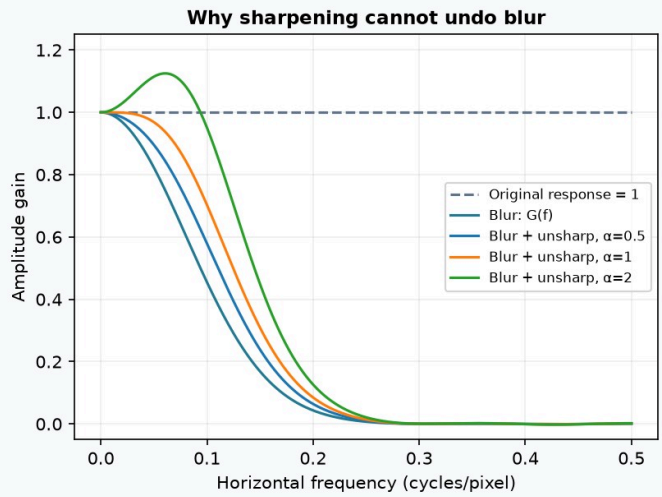
Expanding the unsharp-mask equation gives an equivalent single convolution. The unit impulse δ retains the original image, while the Gaussian term subtracts the blurred component.

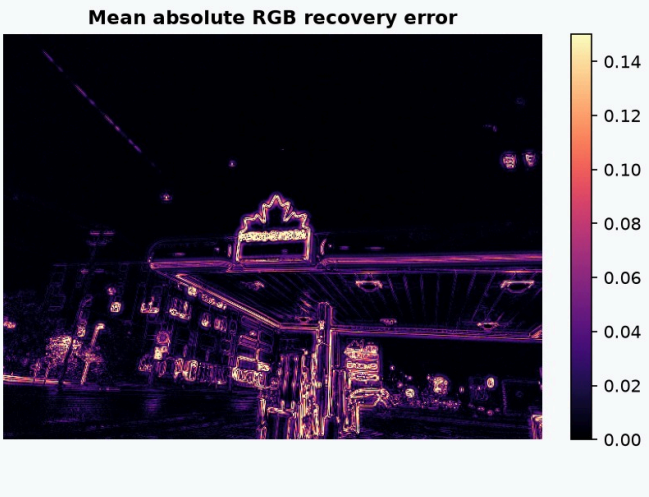
Sharpening kernel

$$S = [(1 + \alpha)\delta - \alpha G] * I$$
$$K = (1 + \alpha)\delta - \alpha G$$

The kernel sums to one and preserves a constant image when the boundary extension also preserves constants. Symmetric extension avoids the dark borders introduced by zero padding. At $\alpha = 1$, this formulation agrees with residual addition to a maximum error of 1.78×10^{-15} across both examples.

Why sharpening does not undo blur





Left: horizontal frequency response of the discrete Gaussian and the combined blur and sharpening operations. Right: mean absolute RGB error against the sharp reference at the selected setting.

Blur then sharpen

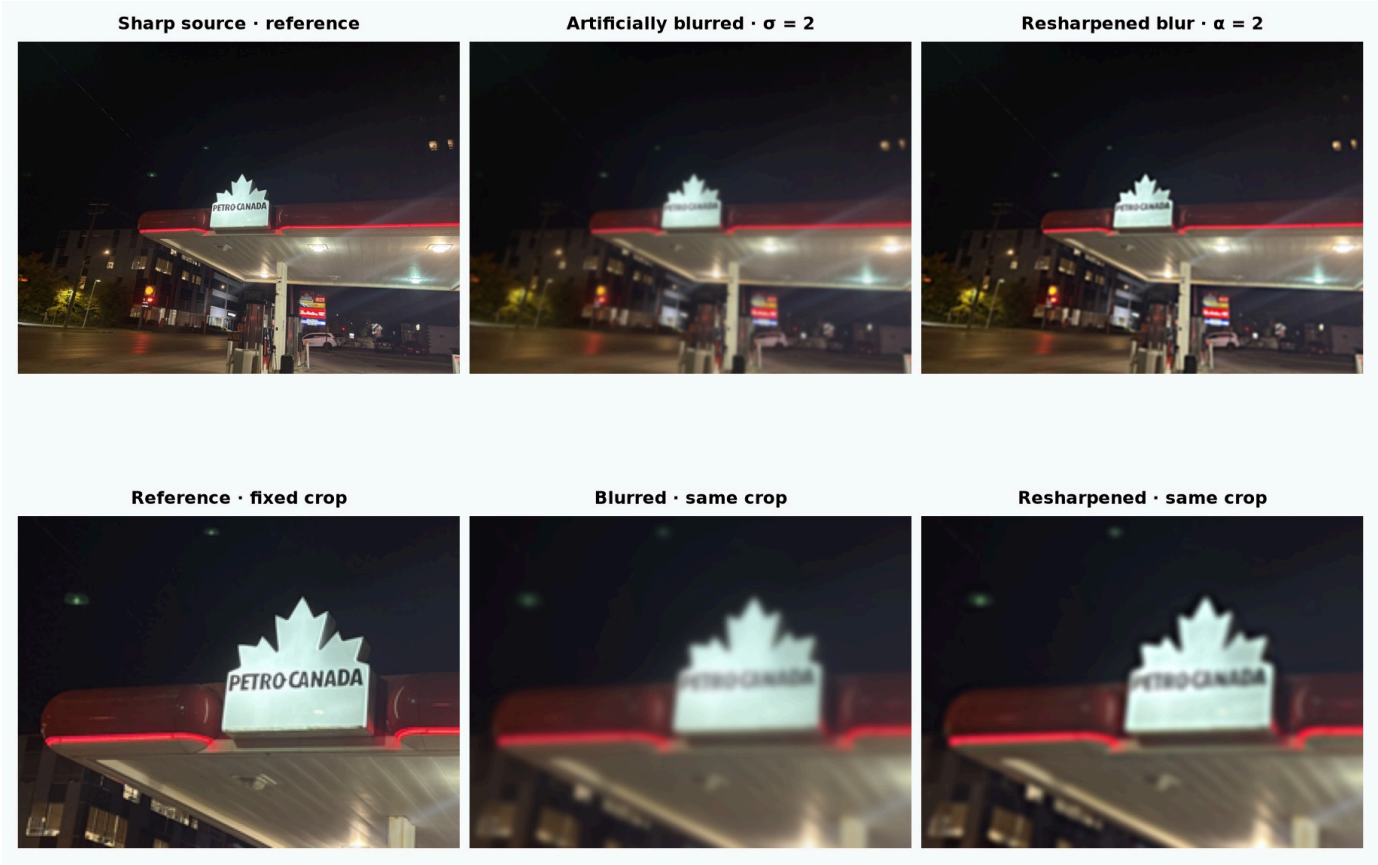
$$R(f) = G(f)[1 + \alpha - \alpha G(f)]$$

The combined frequency response generally differs from one. Frequencies strongly attenuated by the blur remain attenuated after finite amplification, and clipping can remove additional information. The nonzero error map shows that stronger edges do not imply complete recovery of the original detail.

The next comparison measures this loss against the original street photograph. Appendix D gives the single-convolution kernel code.

2.1 Blur and resharpen

The street photograph is first blurred, then sharpened with the same Gaussian. The original photograph provides a reference for the comparison.



Blur and sharpening of the original street photograph. The lower row shows the same fixed region from each image. α = 2 gives the lowest clipped RGB MSE among the three tested settings.

Recovery relative to the original street image · RGB reference in [0, 1]

Stage	α	Unclipped MSE	Unclipped PSNR (dB)	Clipped MSE	Clipped PSNR (dB)
Original	—	0	∞	0	∞
Blurred	—	0.001660	27.80	0.001660	27.80
Resharpened	0.5	0.001429	28.45	0.001429	28.45
Resharpened	1.0	0.001259	29.00	0.001259	29.00
Resharpened	2.0	0.001101	29.58	0.001099	29.59

Of the three tested amounts, α = 2 gives the lowest clipped RGB MSE: 0.001099, compared with 0.001660 after blurring. PSNR rises from 27.80 to 29.59 dB. This setting is selected against the original reference and applies to this experiment.

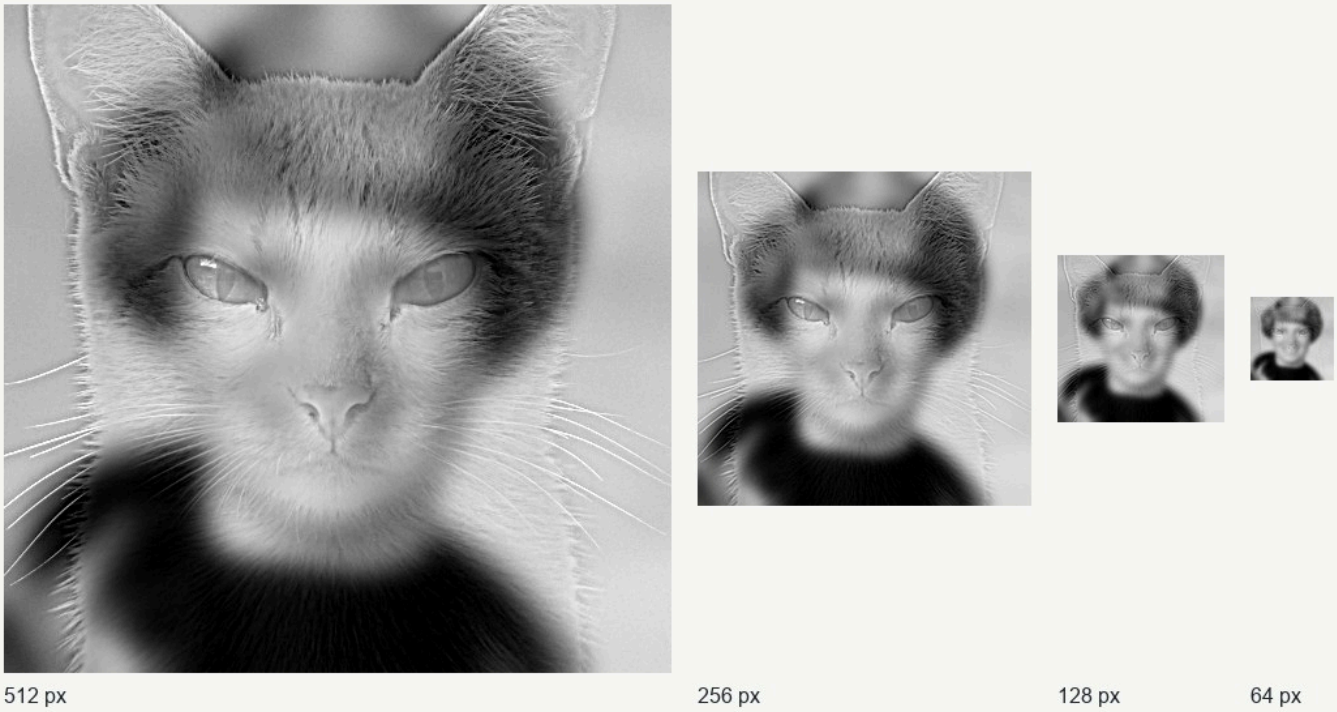
MSE is averaged over all RGB values. With a reference range of [0, 1], PSNR = 10 $\log_{10}(1/\text{MSE})$, in decibels. Both unclipped and display-clipped results are reported.

2.2 Hybrid images at different scales

A hybrid image combines the broad structure of one image with fine detail from another. A blurred portrait supplies the low frequencies. The high-frequency source is a cat photograph or Einstein's portrait.

Hybrid construction $I_{hybrid} = G_{\sigma L} * A + g(B - G_{\sigma H} * B)$

A is the low-frequency source, B is the high-frequency source, g is the detail gain, and Gσ is a Gaussian kernel with standard deviation σ. The symbol ∗ denotes convolution.



Astronaut + portrait cat: the same hybrid at 512, 256, 128 and 64 pixels, reduced with Lanczos.

Cat eyes and muzzle dominate the 512- and 256-pixel views. At 64 pixels, the astronaut's face becomes recognizable. The 128-pixel view retains features from both sources; the change in appearance is gradual.

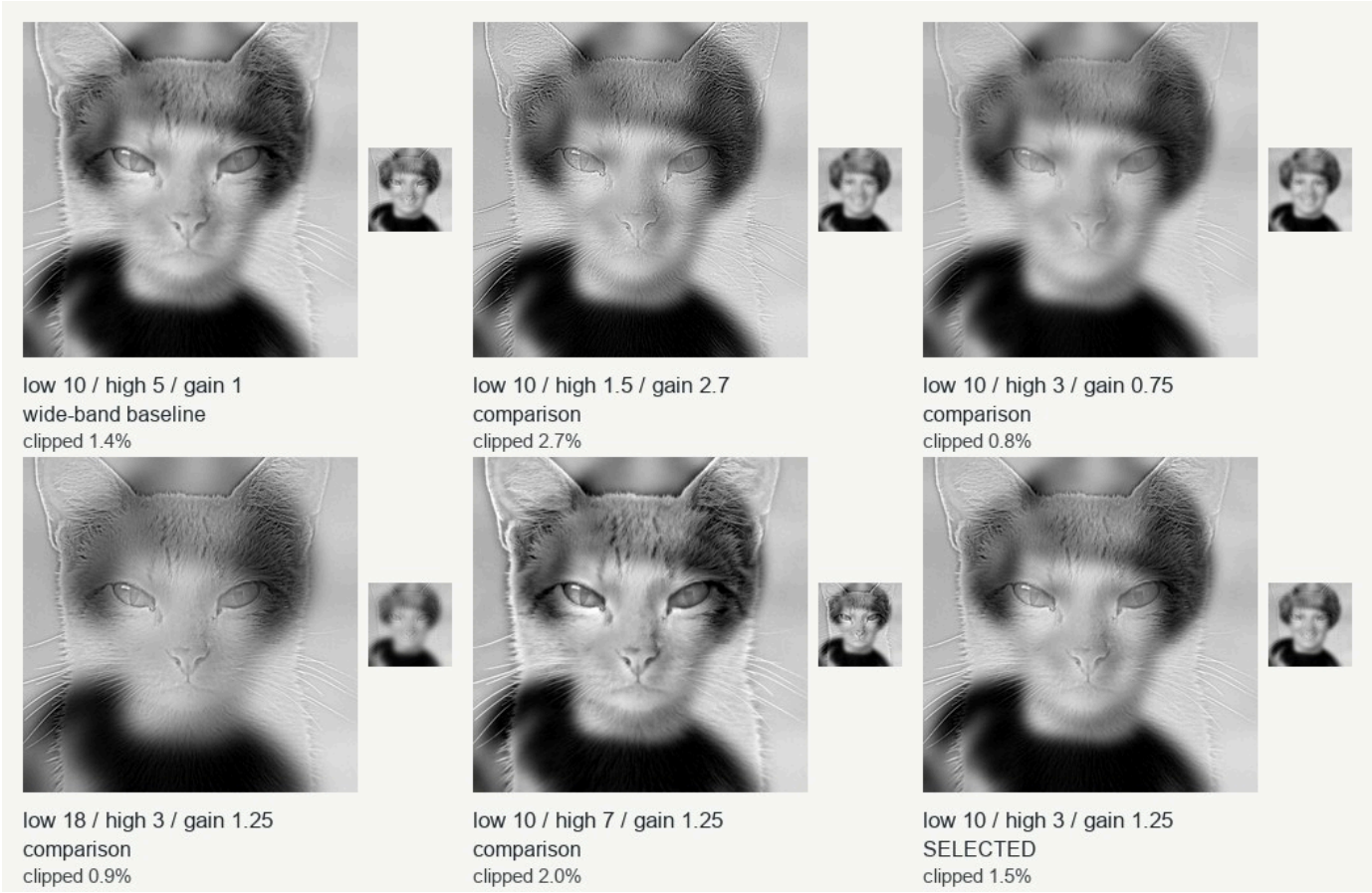
Selected settings at 512 x 512 pixels

Pair	Low-pass sigma (px)	High-pass sigma (px)	Gain	Values clipped
Derek + Nutmeg	8	3	1.25	2.29%
Astronaut + portrait cat	10	3	1.25	1.49%
Obama + Einstein	12	3.5	1	0.36%

For a distance comparison, keep the largest image at a fixed display size and move farther away. The reduced versions provide another comparison; screen size, zoom and eyesight prevent assigning them a calibrated viewing distance.

2.2 Choosing filter widths and gain

Increasing the high-pass σ retains a wider range of detail. A lower gain then softens the bright and dark outlines around fur, wrinkles and hair. Together, these changes reduce the etched appearance of the near views.



Astronaut + portrait cat: filter-width and gain trials, synthesized at 512 x 512 and displayed at 256 and 64 pixels. The selected panel uses the final settings. Alignment remains fixed across the trials.

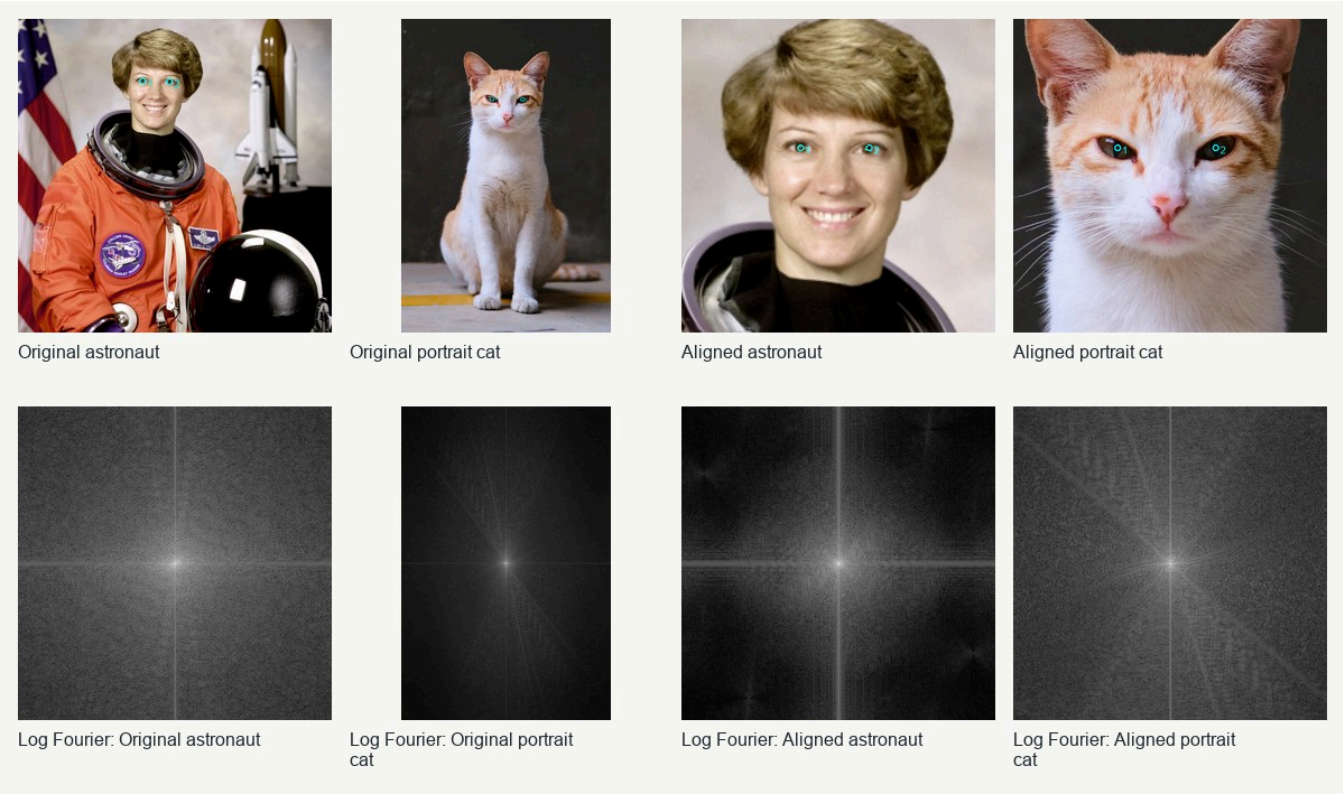
What changes in the trials

The six trials keep alignment fixed. Gain 0.75 makes cat detail less prominent. Increasing the astronaut's low-pass σ to 18 blurs the eyes and smile in the reduced view. High-pass σ = 7 retains more cat structure there, making the change in subject less distinct.

Selected (σL, σH, g) settings are Derek: (8, 3, 1.25); astronaut: (10, 3, 1.25); Obama + Einstein: (12, 3.5, 1). They were chosen visually for these inputs. The controlled comparison below varies alignment and filtering separately.

2.2 Aligning the source images

For the portrait–cat pairs, initial similarity transforms map both pairs of eye centers to (170, 210) and (330, 210). Each transform combines rotation, uniform scale and translation. Exact eye alignment leaves a human mouth or chin below the cat muzzle. This broad structure survives low-pass filtering; adding fur contrast alone does not remove it.



Original and aligned astronaut and portrait-cat inputs. Cyan circles show the alignment landmarks; spectra are calculated from the unmarked images. Both Fourier figures use the same logarithmic scale and display maximum.

Refining the human position

Derek and the astronaut are scaled by 0.70 about (250, 210); Derek is also shifted upward by 12 pixels. The cats remain fixed. The smaller human face places the mouth within the muzzle, although the eyes no longer coincide.

Low-source transform relative to each pair's common eye alignment.

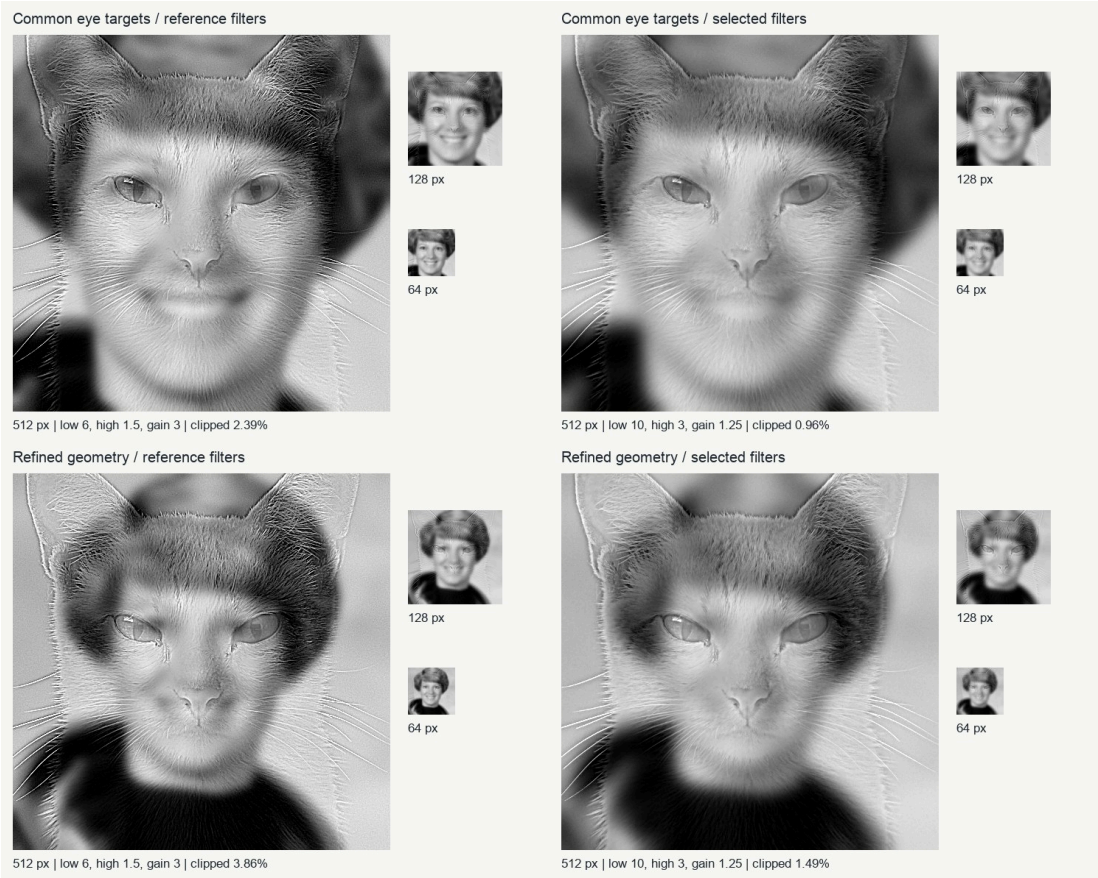
Pair	Scale	Vertical shift (px)	Low-source eye centers (px)
Derek + Nutmeg	0.70	-12	(194, 198); (306, 198)
Astronaut + portrait cat	0.70	0	(194, 210); (306, 210)
Obama + Einstein	1.00	0	(196, 205); (316, 205)

Obama and Einstein share eye targets (196, 205) and (316, 205), without separate refinement. The following astronaut comparison varies geometry and filtering independently.

Each original is resampled once with the composed similarity transform, using bilinear interpolation and replicated borders. Face proportions are unchanged. Original landmarks and exact 2 × 3 matrices are saved with the experiment records.

2.2 Separating geometry and filtering

The four trials vary human position and filter settings independently. The cat transform, source photographs, color treatment and interpolation remain fixed.



Rows compare common-eye and refined geometry; columns compare reference and selected filters. Each trial is shown at 512, 128 and 64 pixels.

Geometry and filtering varied independently for the astronaut pair.

Geometry	(σL, σH, g)	R_{128}	C (%)
Common eyes	(6, 1.5, 3)	0.117	2.39
Common eyes	(10, 3, 1.25)	0.127	0.96
Refined	(6, 1.5, 3)	0.104	3.86
Refined	(10, 3, 1.25)	0.114	1.49

R_{128} is the high-to-low luminance standard-deviation ratio after signed Lanczos reduction to 128 pixels; the high band includes gain g. C is the percentage of scalar channel values outside [0, 1] before display clipping.

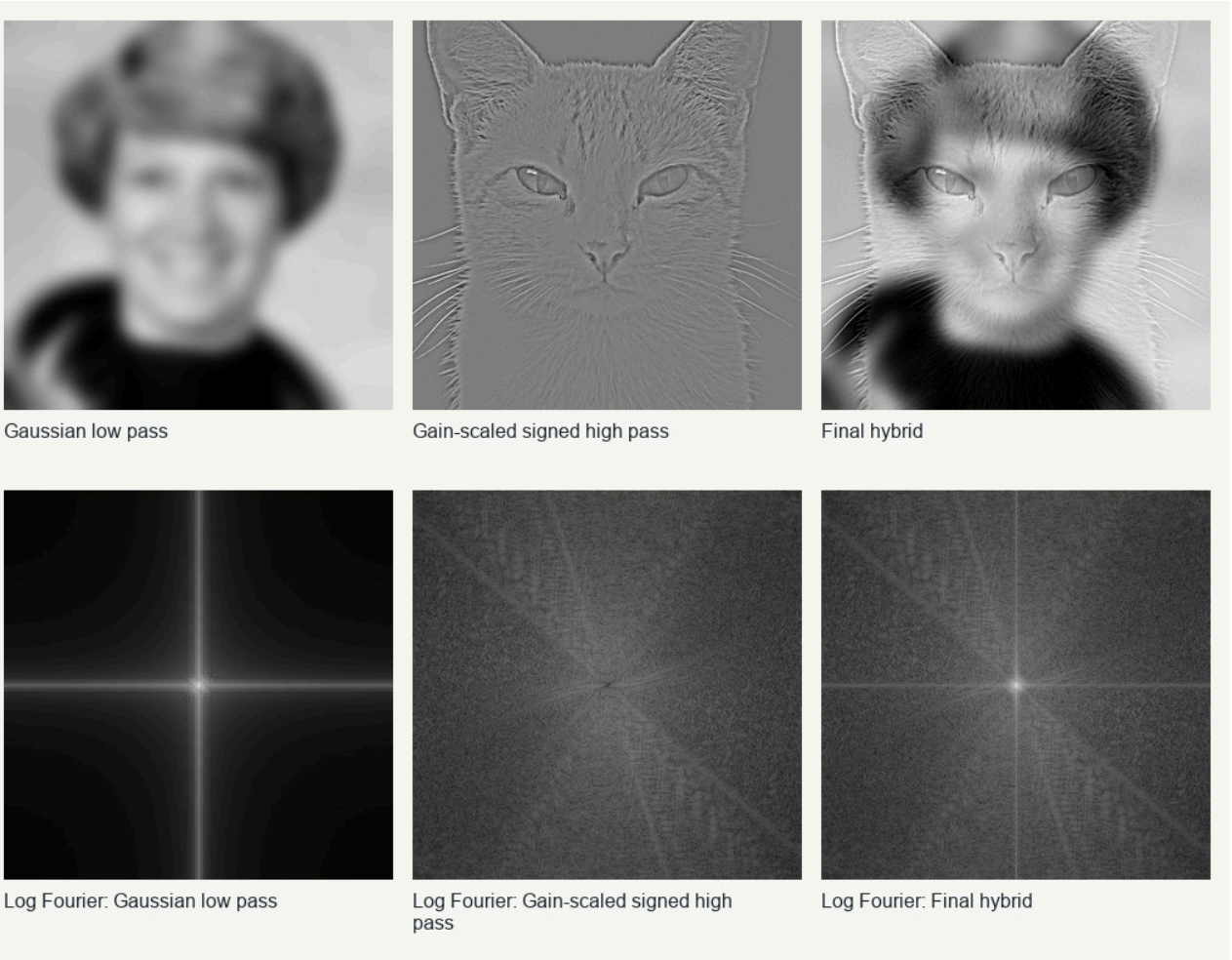
On refined geometry, changing from reference to selected filters changes clipping from 3.86% to 1.49%. With selected filters fixed, refining geometry changes clipping from 0.96% to 1.49%. The smaller human image reduces the separate lower mouth and chin but displaces the eyes. This is a visual tradeoff, not evidence of more accurate landmark registration.

2.2 Frequency content of the hybrid

A Gaussian has no sharp cutoff. Its approximate half-amplitude frequency provides a reference for the selected filter widths.

Half-amplitude frequency $f_{1/2} = \sqrt{(2 \ln 2)} / (2\pi\sigma)$

For the astronaut pair, the low-pass and complementary high-pass values are 0.0187 and 0.0625 cycles per output pixel, respectively. Filtering uses spatial convolution; Fourier plots show the resulting frequency content.



Gaussian low pass | Gain-scaled signed high pass | Final hybrid

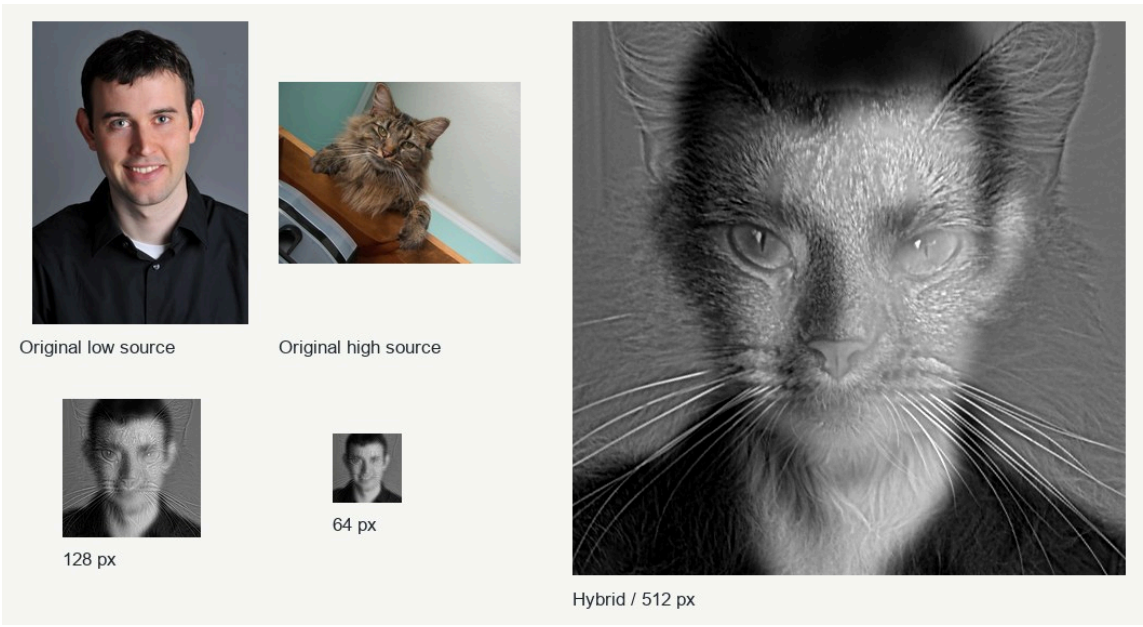
Log Fourier: Gaussian low pass | Log Fourier: Gain-scaled signed high pass | Log Fourier: Final hybrid

Low-pass energy is concentrated near the center; the high-pass suppresses central energy and retains fine detail. Adding the two components produces the hybrid. Both Fourier figures use the same logarithmic scale and display maximum.

Fourier display $\log(1 + 1{,}000{,}000\ |\text{fftshift}(\text{fft2}(Y))| / N)$

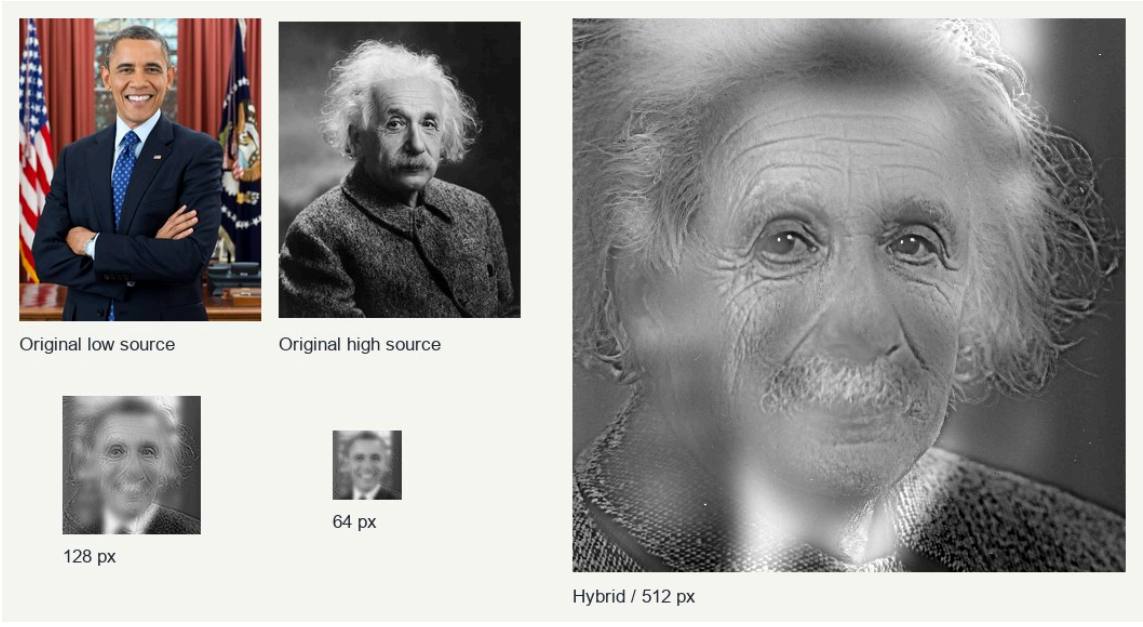
Y is luminance and N is the number of image pixels. Division by N permits comparison of differently sized inputs. The source and process spectra share one display maximum. No window or mean subtraction is applied.

2.2 Two further hybrid examples



Derek + Nutmeg: original sources and the final hybrid at 512, 128 and 64 pixels.

The smaller human face reduces the separate mouth and chin below the cat muzzle. Nutmeg dominates at 512 pixels; Derek becomes recognizable at 64 pixels. The 128-pixel view retains features from both sources.



Obama + Einstein: original sources and the final hybrid at 512, 128 and 64 pixels.

Einstein's hair, wrinkles and moustache dominate the 512-pixel view. Obama's broader face and smile become clearer at 64 pixels; the 128-pixel view remains mixed. The selected (σL, σH, g) = (12, 3.5, 1) retains Einstein's facial detail with softer edge contrast. Broad shading from Obama's face remains in the low band; changing the high-band gain cannot remove that component.

Supplementary figures retain each pair's registration, components and parameter comparisons, plus the Earth + Moon limitation study. Its similar outlines and overlapping surface structure do not produce a clear change in perceived subject.

Additional parameter trials and diagnostic figures are available in the online supplement.

2.2 Comparing the frequency bands

Two diagnostics describe the selected hybrids and a common baseline. The band-contrast ratio measures the relative variation in the two components; the clipping fraction records how much of their sum exceeds the display range.

Relative band contrast at width s

$$R_s = \mathrm{std}(D_s(H)) \,/\, \mathrm{std}(D_s(L))$$

L is low-pass luminance and H is gain-scaled high-pass luminance. D_s reduces each signed component to width s with Lanczos interpolation; the native 512-pixel arrays are unchanged. Standard deviations use all pixels. Neither component is clipped or contrast-normalized.

Strict clipping fraction

$$C = \mathrm{count}(I_{hybrid} < 0 \text{ or } I_{hybrid} > 1) \,/\, \mathrm{count}(\text{all channel values})$$

The same diagnostics for all three hybrid pairs.

Pair	Setting	R_{512}	R_{128}	C (%)
Derek + Nutmeg	Baseline	0.319	0.240	1.89
Derek + Nutmeg	Selected	0.323	0.199	2.29
Astronaut + portrait cat	Baseline	0.194	0.145	1.36
Astronaut + portrait cat	Selected	0.197	0.114	1.49
Obama + Einstein	Baseline	0.358	0.262	0.54
Obama + Einstein	Selected	0.326	0.208	0.36

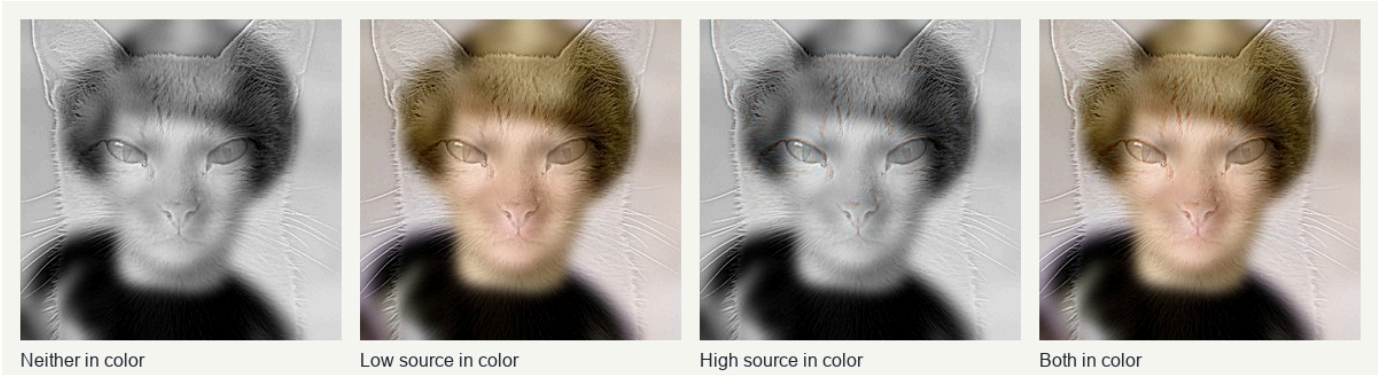
The baseline uses (σL, σH, g) = (10, 5, 1) on each pair's selected geometry. Selected settings are listed with the hybrid results. This baseline differs from the (6, 1.5, 3) reference used in the preceding geometry comparison.

For all three selected pairs, R decreases from 512 to 128 pixels: the fine-detail band loses contrast relative to the broad low-frequency band. The baseline provides the same measurements on the same geometry, allowing the filter choices to be compared without changing alignment.

These measurements describe the bands, not identity recognition. For the portrait–cat pairs, moving the broad human smile into the cat muzzle improves the near view. All three examples retain mixed intermediate views. A larger ratio or a smaller clipping fraction alone cannot establish a cleaner change in perceived subject.

2.2 Color in the frequency bands

Four variants retain color in neither source, only the low-frequency source, only the high-frequency source, or both. Alignment, filter widths and gain remain identical.



Four color variants with identical alignment, filter widths and gain. Luminance conversion uses weights 0.2126, 0.7152 and 0.0722. Color in the low-frequency source preserves broad skin and hair regions; color in the high-frequency source remains mainly around cat edges and fur.

How color changes the result

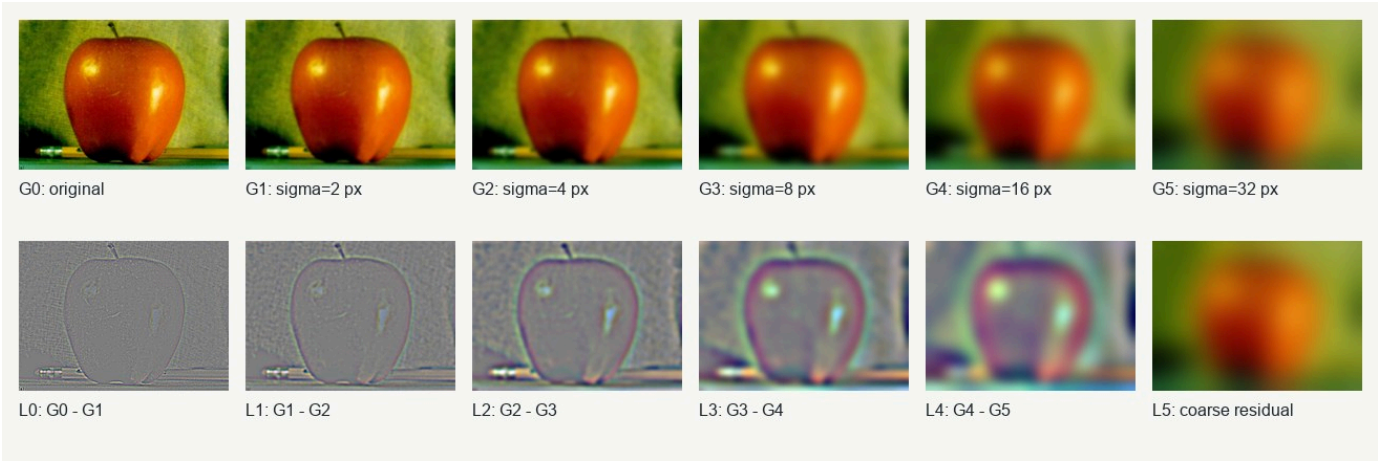
Low-frequency color preserves the astronaut's broad skin and hair regions, agreeing with the face visible at smaller sizes. Grayscale fur remains visible at larger sizes. High-frequency color remains mainly around fine cat edges because filtering removes the broad coat color.

Keeping color in both sources adds competing hues around some cat edges. The main hybrid examples use grayscale so the visible subject can be assessed without this broad color difference.

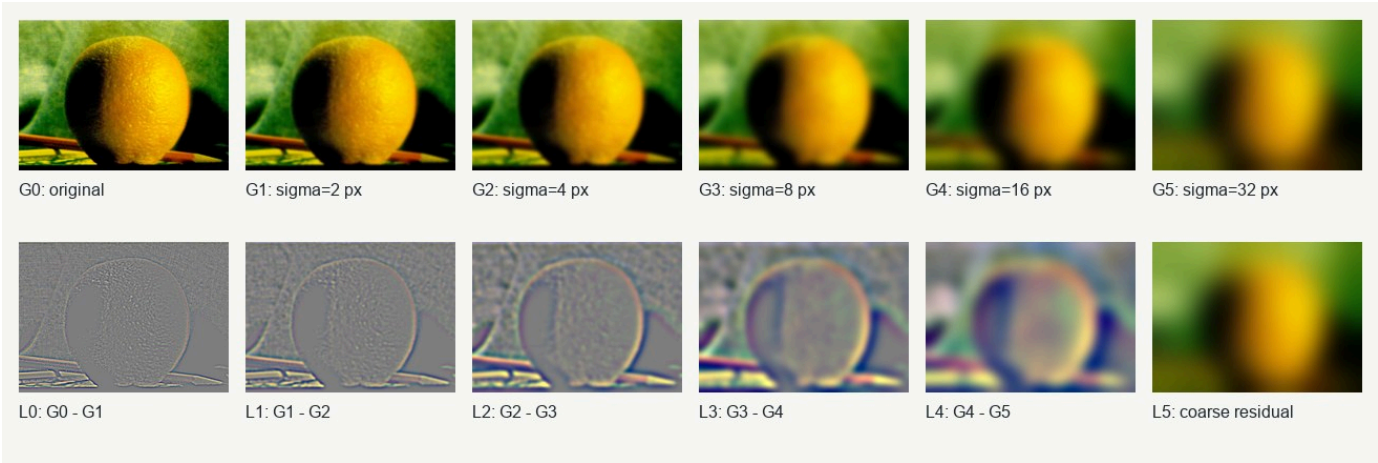
2.3 Gaussian and Laplacian stacks

The supplied burt_apple.png and burt_orange.png images are each 740 × 530 pixels. One resize with area interpolation gives 512 × 367 working images, reducing computation while preserving aspect ratio to the nearest output pixel.

Every Gaussian-stack level keeps the same dimensions. G_0 is the original; G_1 through G_5 independently blur it at σ = 2, 4, 8, 16 and 32 pixels. Each width therefore refers to the original image. Construction is explicit, with no downsampling or built-in pyramid routine.



Apple: Gaussian stack above and Laplacian stack below, including the coarse residual. Every level retains the working resolution of 512 × 367 pixels. Signed detail bands use 0.5 + 2.5L for display; the residual uses its actual intensity.



Orange: Gaussian stack above and Laplacian stack below, including the coarse residual. Every level retains the working resolution of 512 × 367 pixels. Signed detail bands use 0.5 + 2.5L for display; the residual uses its actual intensity.

Laplacian detail and residual $L_i = G_i - G_{i+1}$ $(i = 0, \ldots, 4)$; $L_5 = G_5$

The five detail bands sum to the original minus G_5. Adding the coarse residual restores large-scale brightness and color, reconstructing the image up to floating-point rounding.

2.3 Reconstructing the oraple

The selected levels show how each source contributes at different scales. The final row sums all five detail bands and the coarse residual.

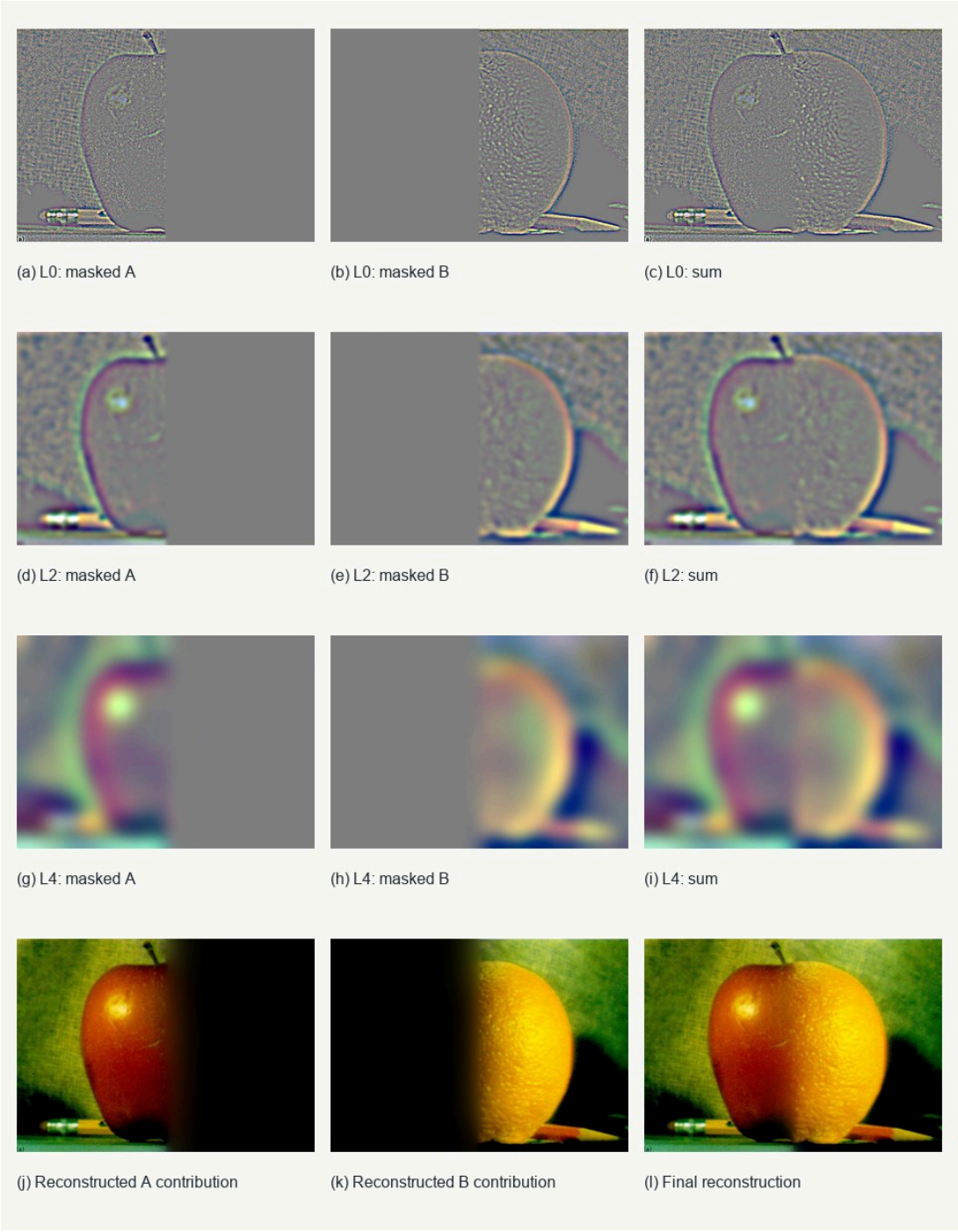


Figure 3.42 (a)–(l) layout: rows 1–3 show levels 0, 2, and 4; columns show the masked apple, masked orange, and their sum. Row 4 sums all five detail bands and the coarse residual to reconstruct the two contributions and final oraple. Detail bands share a symmetric display scale within each row; reconstructed images use actual [0, 1] intensity.

2.4 A transition that changes with scale

A binary mask selects apple on the left and orange on the right. Its Gaussian stack uses the same smoothing scales as the image stacks.

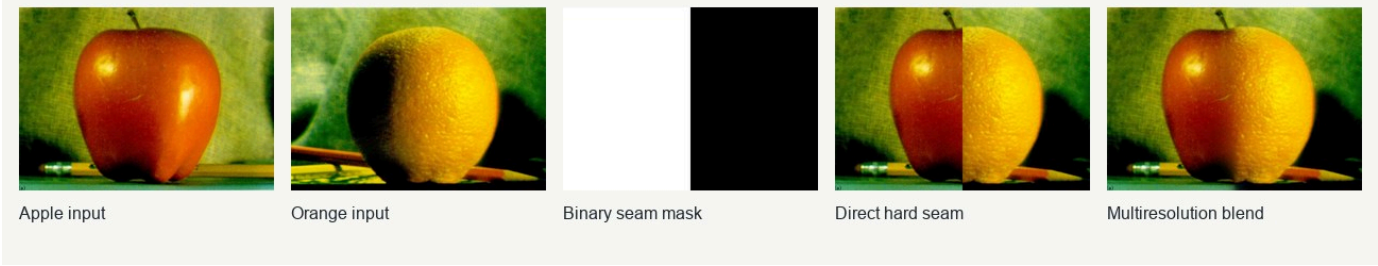


Gaussian stack of the left/right selection mask, using the same scales as the image stacks. The transition widens at coarser levels. White selects apple and black selects orange.

Blend each band, then sum

$$S_i = M_i L_{A,i} + (1 - M_i) L_{B,i}; \quad I_{blend} = \Sigma_{i=0}^{5} S_i$$

The rule includes the coarse residual. The finest mask has a sharp transition; coarser masks spread brightness and color changes across wider regions while retaining local texture.



Supplied inputs, selection mask, direct binary cut, and multiresolution oraple. Both methods use the same 512 × 367 images with preserved aspect ratio. The seam lies between zero-based columns 255 and 256.

Both methods use the same inputs and initial mask. The direct cut leaves a visible vertical change in brightness and color. The mean absolute RGB difference across adjoining seam columns falls from 0.1716 to 0.0279 with multiresolution blending. This measures the local discontinuity, not overall perceptual quality.

Reconstruction accuracy

Comparison	Maximum absolute error
Apple reconstruction	1.110e-16
Orange reconstruction	2.220e-16
Final image vs. sum of mixed bands	3.331e-16

The seam lies between zero-based columns 255 and 256. Measurement uses the floating-point reconstruction before clipping. Stack construction and reconstruction remain unclipped; display export limits 2.35% of scalar RGB values to [0, 1].

2.4 Adding the bands one level at a time

Starting with the mixed coarse residual S_5, add the five detail contributions from coarse to fine. Every addition uses arrays of the same size; no interpolation or resizing occurs.

Cumulative reconstruction $T_5 = S_5; \quad T_k = T_{k+1} + S_k, \quad k = 4, \ldots, 0$



Read left to right, then top to bottom. All panels use the same [0, 1] display limits, with no contrast normalization. Measurements use the signed arrays before clipping.

All levels remain 512 × 367 RGB; σ is in output pixels.

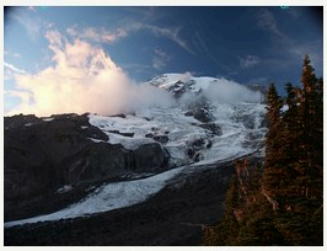
Step	Added band	Mask σ	Remaining RMS
1	S5	32	0.10923
2	S4	16	0.07960
3	S3	8	0.05434
4	S2	4	0.03644
5	S1	2	0.02469
6	S0	0	3.25e-17

Remaining RMS = $\sqrt{\text{mean}[(I_{\text{blend}} - T_k)^2]}$, over all pixels and RGB channels. The reference is the complete computed blend, not an ideal photograph. The final difference is floating-point roundoff; intermediate RMS need not decrease for arbitrary signed bands.

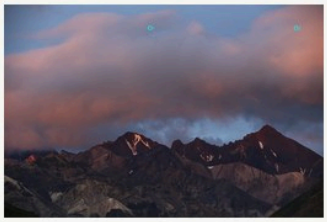
Omitting S_5 leaves RMS error 0.39660: the detail bands cannot restore broad brightness and color. Including it reconstructs the full blend to numerical precision. This checks completeness of the summation, not visual quality.

2.4 A different sky above the mountain

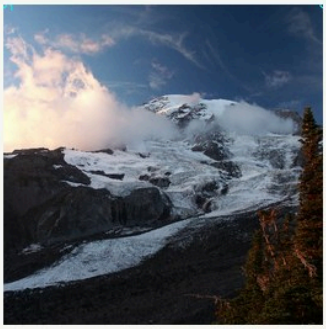
The composite places Mount Rainier below a warm cloud field photographed above Denali. A 38-vertex polygon follows the visible cloud and mountain silhouette, retaining the summit, glacier, foreground trees and bright cloud on the left.



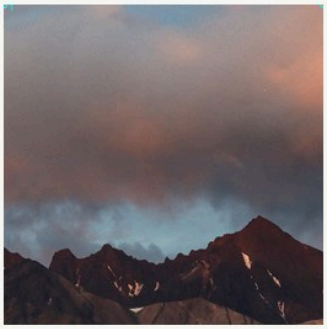
Original A: Mount Rainier and Nisqually Glacier



Original B: Sunset clouds above Denali



Framed A: 512 x 512



Framed B: corrected RGB

Mountain-sky blending: original and framed photographs. Cyan circles mark independent framing controls that set cropping and uniform scale; they are not correspondences between the two places. After framing, B uses uniform RGB gains (1.12, 1.1, 0.96) in stored RGB space, with no intermediate clipping. The original photographs above remain unmodified. Mount Rainier: U.S. National Park Service, public domain. Denali sunset: NPS / Emily Mesner, public domain. The composite joins photographs of different places; it is not a record of a real scene.

Preparing the photographs

Independent framing points crop and uniformly scale each photograph; they are not corresponding features of one scene. Bilinear sampling uses replicated borders. The selected sky crop includes warmer clouds at the upper right. Uniform RGB gains then reduce its purple-blue cast.

Global sky color adjustment

$$B'(x, y) = (1.12\ B_R,\ 1.10\ B_G,\ 0.96\ B_B)$$

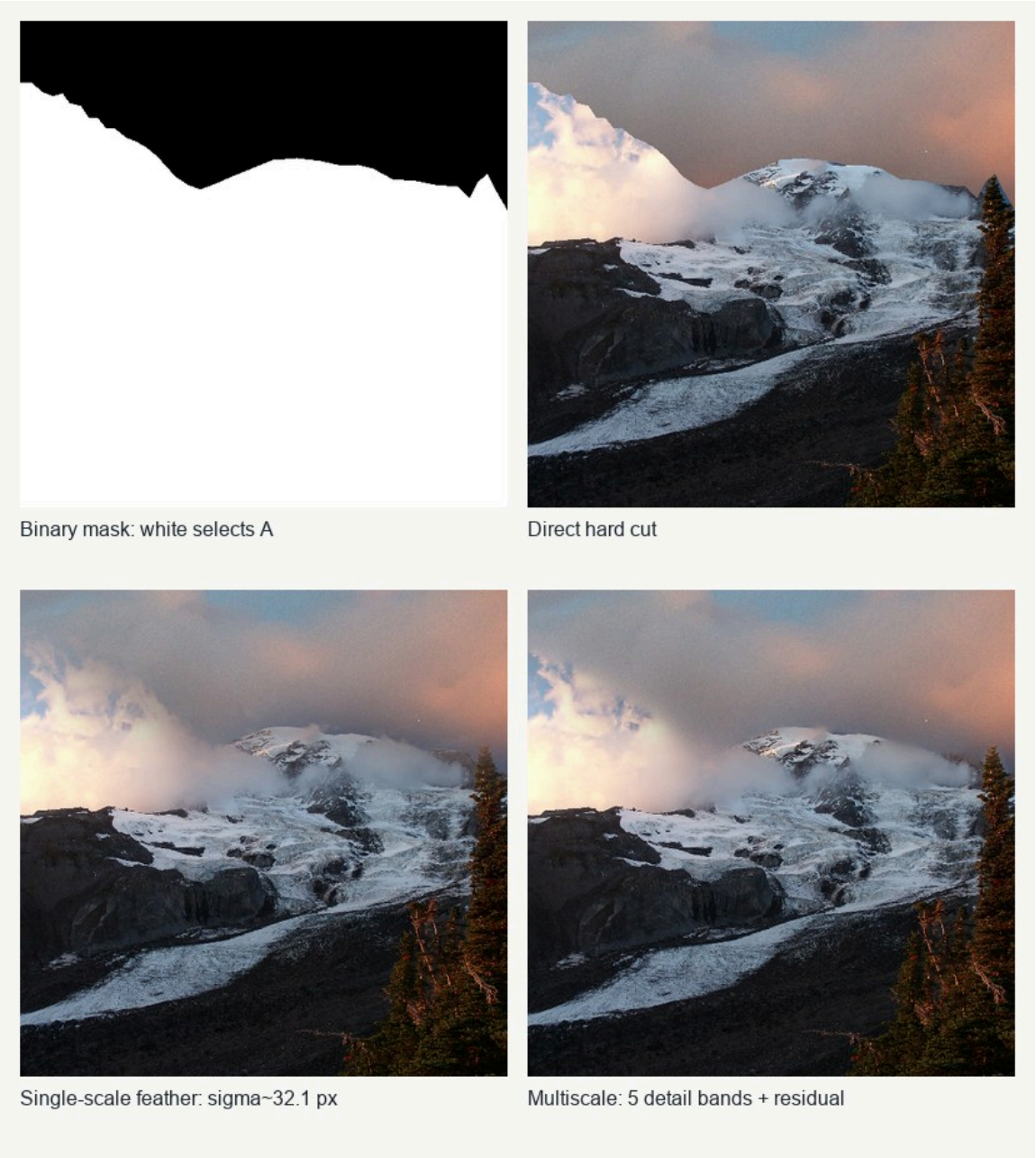
Gains multiply stored RGB values after framing, without intermediate clipping. This empirical adjustment is not physical relighting. The supplement compares the original crop, the new crop alone, and the new crop with gains; the mask and stack remain fixed.

All three methods use the same prepared inputs and binary selection. Feathering applies the coarsest Gaussian mask to the full images. Multiresolution blending applies the corresponding mask to each band.

Five detail bands use image $\sigma = 2, 4, 8, 16$ and 32 pixels, plus the coarse residual. Initial mask $\sigma = 2$ softens polygon corners while preserving the summit. Nominal mask widths are $\sqrt{(2^2 + \sigma^2)}$, giving 2, 2.8, 4.5, 8.2, 16.1 and 32.1 pixels across the six levels.

2.4 Landscape blending: boundary and texture

The direct cut exposes the polygon above the summit and left cloud. Broad feathering mixes cloud texture through the ridge and makes the summit partly transparent.

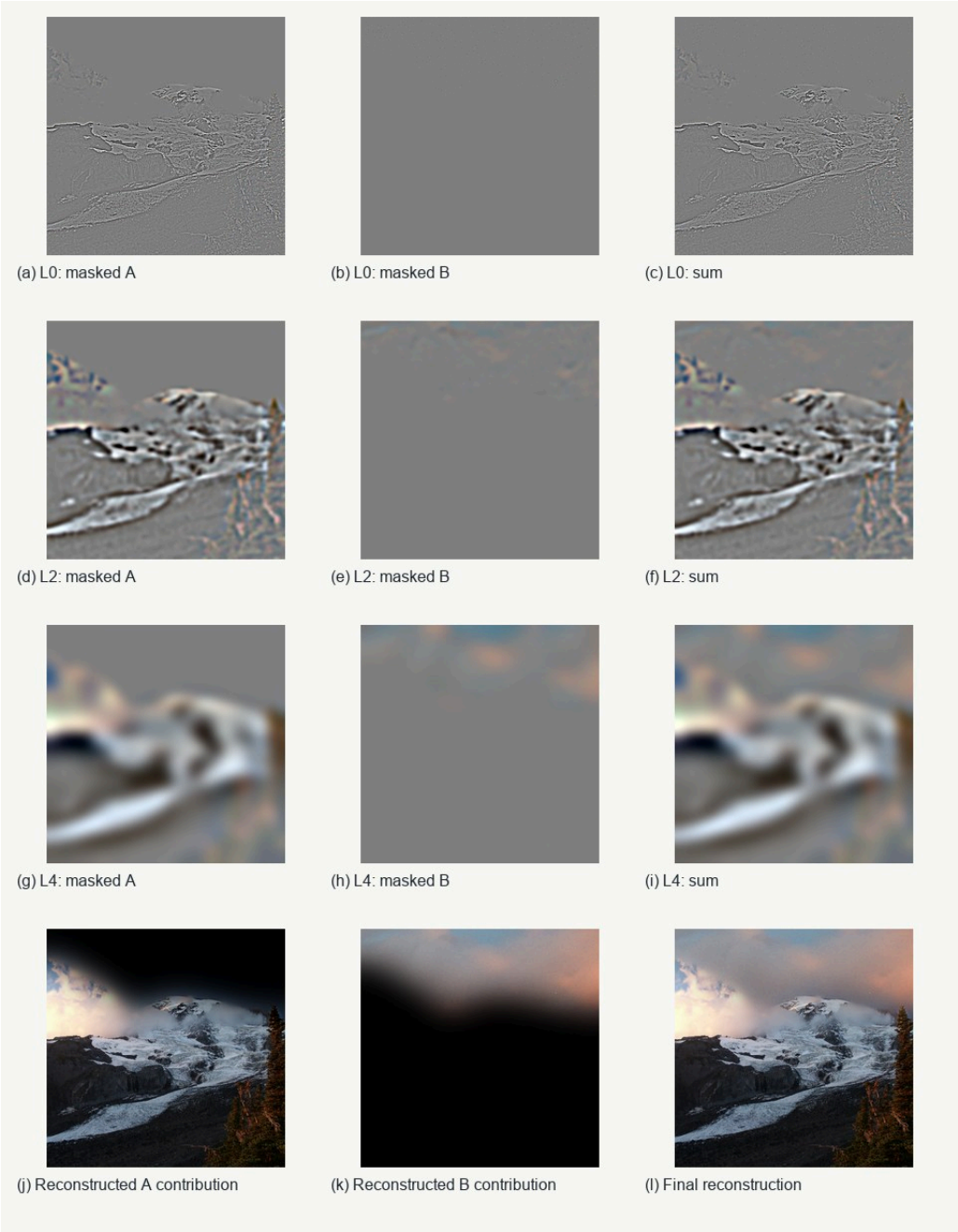


Three methods with the same input arrays and binary selection. The mask is initially smoothed at σ = 2 pixels before constructing the mask stack.

Multiresolution blending retains more local rock and snow contrast while spreading the broad sky-color transition. The warmer sky is closer in color to the retained cloud on the left. The two cloud fields still have different brightness patterns; the adjustment does not establish common illumination or a real scene.

2.4 Landscape contributions at each scale

The band-count differences are modest. A maximum image σ of 16 leaves a narrower color transition. σ = 32 spreads it locally; σ = 64 transfers more of the sky color over the snow. Five bands balance these effects.

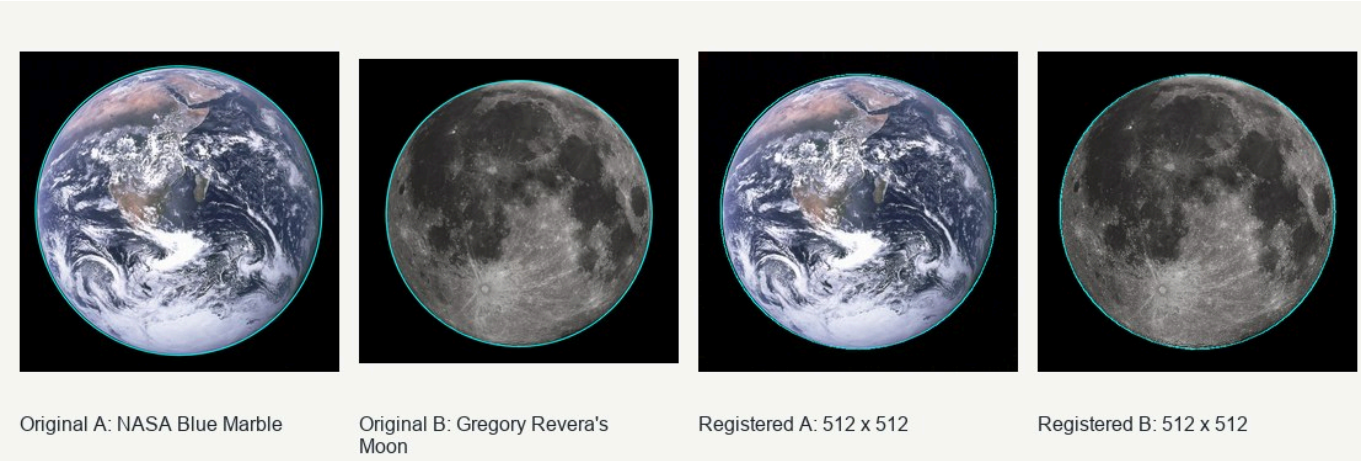


Mountain-sky blending: rows 1–3 show masked A, masked B and their sum at Laplacian levels 0, 2 and 4. The final row reconstructs each contribution and the result using all detail bands plus the coarse residual, following Burt–Adelson Figure 10. Each detail row uses one shared symmetric contrast scale; reconstructed rows retain actual intensity.

Supplementary trials compare four, five and six detail bands with other inputs fixed. Initial-mask trials compare σ = 0, 2, 4, 8, 12 and 16 pixels. Widths of 0, 2 and 4 give similar results. The selected σ = 2 softens corners; widths of 8–16 fade cloud wisps and the summit more.

2.4 Joining Earth and Moon

An S-shaped boundary joins Earth's oceans and clouds to lunar craters. The similar disk outlines support this composite, although the same photographs did not produce a clear subject change in the hybrid experiment.



Earth-Moon blending: original and registered photographs. Cyan outlines mark the fitted source ellipses and target circle. The larger axis scale factor exceeds the smaller by 1.06% for Earth and 0.03% for the Moon. Earth: NASA/Apollo 17, public domain. Moon: Gregory H. Revera, CC BY-SA 3.0. The adapted composite and Moon-derived figures are distributed under CC BY-SA 3.0.

The largest source contours above luminance 0.04 are fitted with cv2.fitEllipse and mapped affinely to a circle of radius 220 pixels at (256, 256). Thresholding measures the outlines only; the transforms sample original RGB pixels. Earth's axis scale factors differ by 1.06%; the Moon's differ by 0.03%.

Earth–Moon uses six detail bands, adding image $\sigma = 64$ pixels, plus the coarse residual. The initial mask uses $\sigma = 8$, giving one further nominal mask width of 64.5 pixels.

Identical inputs and selections within each example.

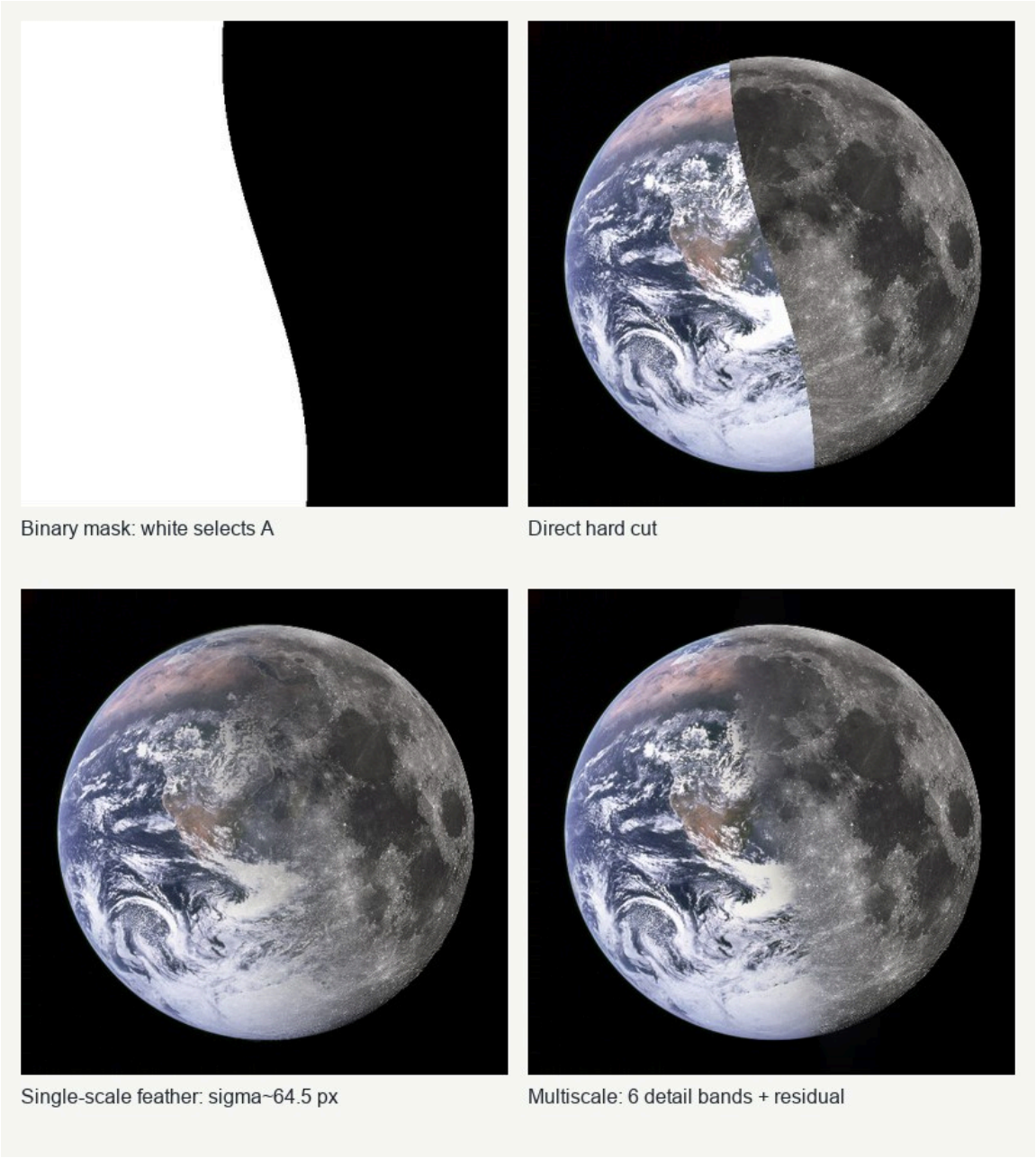
Example	Hard J	Feather J	Multi J	Hard Cε (%)	Feather Cε (%)	Multi Cε (%)
Oraple	0.1716	0.0122	0.0279	0.00	0.00	0.94
Mountain-sky	0.2366	0.0266	0.0306	0.00	0.00	0.00
Earth-Moon	0.2718	0.0422	0.0424	0.00	0.00	4.45

J is mean absolute RGB difference across adjacent pixels straddling the original binary contour, before clipping. Cε is the fraction of scalar values below -10^{-6} or above $1 + 10^{-6}$. This tolerance discounts roundoff and negligible excursions; strict counts and ranges remain in the measurements.

Feathering gives the smallest J but mixes more texture. A smaller boundary jump alone does not establish a better composite. The disk fit checks outline coincidence, not surface-feature correspondence or physical realism.

2.4 Planet blending: brightness and detail

The Earth–Moon blend uses a maximum image σ of 64 pixels because the brightness mismatch extends across much of the disk. Fewer bands leave a more visible boundary.



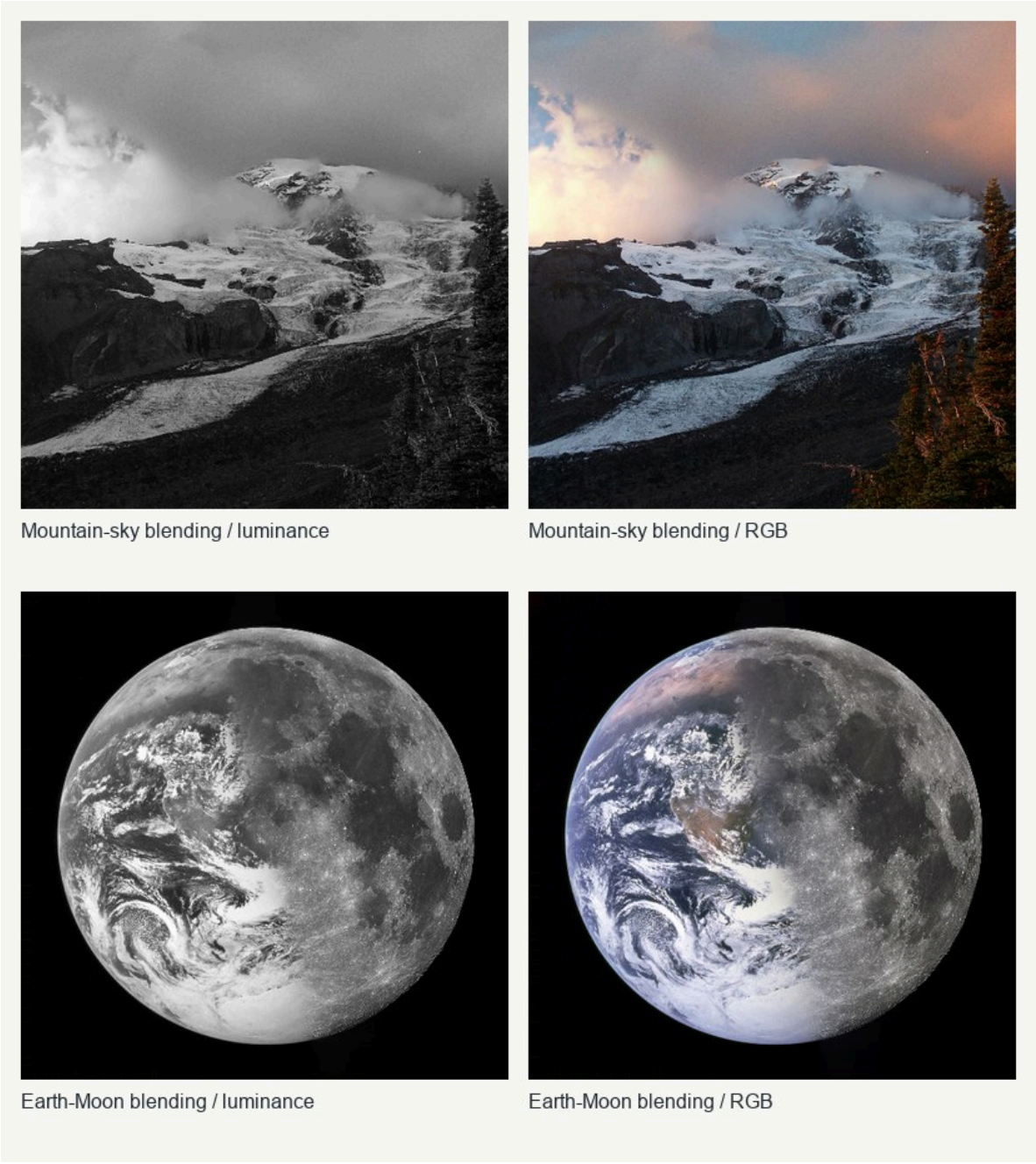
Three methods with the same registered inputs and binary selection. Initial mask smoothing at σ = 8 pixels reduces the abrupt contrast change where the selection meets the disk outline.

Multiresolution blending reduces the brightness step and keeps cloud and crater detail more localized than broad feathering. A binary finest mask leaves an abrupt outer-edge join; wider masks combine texture across a larger region. The same six initial widths and four-, five- and six-band comparisons are retained in the supplementary figures.

The composite remains an imaginary surface: lunar features do not continue Earth's clouds. Smoothing a boundary cannot reconcile different surface structures.

2.4 Color separates the source regions

The final composites use RGB. Warm clouds and orange-green foreground trees give the landscape stronger regional color differences. Blue oceans distinguish Earth from the nearly neutral Moon. These differences are less distinct in grayscale, although the boundaries remain smoothed.



Luminance and RGB results with the same registration, masks and stack settings. Luminance is 0.2126R + 0.7152G + 0.0722B; RGB channels are blended independently.

Framing or registration, color preparation, masks and stack settings are identical in this comparison. RGB channels are blended independently. Supplementary figures retain the landscape lighting comparison, matched boundary crops, mask stacks, initial-mask sweeps and band-count trials.

Additional parameter trials and diagnostic figures are available in the online supplement.

IMPLEMENTATION APPENDIX

A Convolution implementation

The shared helper validates the inputs, reverses the kernel, and pads the image with zeros. Both implementations return the same image shape and use the same padding convention.

Input validation, kernel reversal, and padding

```
def _convolution_inputs(image, kernel):
    image = np.asarray(image, dtype=np.float64)
    kernel = np.asarray(kernel, dtype=np.float64)
    if image.ndim != 2 or kernel.ndim != 2:
        raise ValueError('image and kernel must both be two dimensional')
    if not image.size or not kernel.size:
        raise ValueError('image and kernel must be nonempty')
    kh, kw = kernel.shape
    padded = np.pad(image, ((kh // 2, (kh - 1) // 2), (kw // 2, (kw - 1) // 2)),
mode='constant')
    return (image, kernel[::-1, ::-1], padded)
```

Four-loop convolution

```
def convolve_four_loops(image, kernel):
    image, flipped, padded = _convolution_inputs(image, kernel)
    height, width = image.shape
    kh, kw = flipped.shape
    out = np.zeros_like(image)
    for y in range(height):
        for x in range(width):
            for ky in range(kh):
                for kx in range(kw):
                    out[y, x] += flipped[ky, kx] * padded[y + ky, x + kx]
    return out
```

IMPLEMENTATION APPENDIX

B Vectorization and image gradients

The two-loop version accumulates a complete shifted image slice for each kernel element. This changes the Python loop structure without changing the convolution sum.

Two-loop convolution

```
def convolve_two_loops(image, kernel):
    image, flipped, padded = _convolution_inputs(image, kernel)
    height, width = image.shape
    kh, kw = flipped.shape
    out = np.zeros_like(image)
    for ky in range(kh):
        for kx in range(kw):
            out += flipped[ky, kx] * padded[ky:ky + height, kx:kx + width]
    return out
```

Gradient and edge magnitude

```
gx = convolve_two_loops(image, DX)
gy = convolve_two_loops(image, DY)
magnitude = np.sqrt(gx * gx + gy * gy)
edges = magnitude > threshold
```

Cameraman input preparation

The supplied image has a thin white border. The crop (1, 7, 535, 541), in (left, top, right, bottom) coordinates with the right and bottom bounds excluded, removes it. The square crop is resized to 256 × 256 pixels with Lanczos interpolation.

Calculations use floating-point intensities in [0, 1] with no further normalization before thresholding. The seven-pixel evaluation margin covers the largest Gaussian-derivative support used in Part 1.

IMPLEMENTATION APPENDIX

C Orientation without angle routines

For nonzero gradients, the ratio below lies in [0, 1]. When it exceeds $\sqrt{2}-1$, range reduction bounds the series argument by $\sqrt{2}-1$. Eighteen terms approximate arctangent; component swaps and signs recover the quadrant.

Range reduction

$$r = \min(|g_y|, |g_x|) \,/\, \max(|g_y|, |g_x|)$$

$$\operatorname{atan}(r) = \pi/4 + \operatorname{atan}((r-1)/(r+1)) \quad \text{for } r > \sqrt{2}-1$$

$$\operatorname{atan}(z) \approx z - z^3/3 + z^5/5 - \dots$$

Arithmetic-only orientation implementation

```
def orientation_without_angles(gx, gy, terms=18):
    gx, gy = np.broadcast_arrays(np.asarray(gx, float), np.asarray(gy, float))
    if not np.all(np.isfinite(gx)) or not np.all(np.isfinite(gy)):
        raise ValueError('gradient components must be finite')
    if terms < 1:
        raise ValueError('terms must be positive')
    ax, ay = (np.abs(gx), np.abs(gy))
    high, low = (np.maximum(ax, ay), np.minimum(ax, ay))
    ratio = np.divide(low, high, out=np.zeros_like(high), where=high != 0)
    reduce = ratio > np.sqrt(2.0) - 1.0
    z = np.where(reduce, (ratio - 1.0) / (ratio + 1.0), ratio)
    z2 = z * z
    poly = np.zeros_like(z)
    for n in range(terms - 1, -1, -1):
        poly = (-1.0) ** n / (2 * n + 1) + z2 * poly
    small_angle = z * poly + np.where(reduce, np.pi / 4, 0.0)
    angle = np.where(ay > ax, np.pi / 2 - small_angle, small_angle)
    angle = np.where(gx < 0, np.pi - angle, angle)
    angle = np.where(gy < 0, -angle, angle)
    return np.where(high == 0, 0.0, angle)
```

A zero gradient is assigned orientation zero and displayed black. NumPy atan2 is used only as an independent validation reference.

D Gaussian derivatives and sharpening

Full convolution retains the complete Gaussian-derivative support. The sharpening kernel combines the identity and Gaussian terms into one image convolution.

Build Gaussian derivative kernels

```
g1 = cv2.getGaussianKernel(13, 2.0)
G = g1 @ g1.T
Kx = convolve2d(G, DX, mode='full')
Ky = convolve2d(G, DY, mode='full')
gx = convolve2d(image, Kx, mode='same', boundary='fill')
gy = convolve2d(image, Ky, mode='same', boundary='fill')
```

Single-convolution sharpening kernel

```
def unsharp_kernel(gaussian, alpha):
    gaussian = np.asarray(gaussian, float)
    if gaussian.ndim != 2 or any((n % 2 == 0 for n in gaussian.shape)):
        raise ValueError('Gaussian must have odd dimensions')
    if not np.isclose(gaussian.sum(), 1.0):
        raise ValueError('Gaussian must sum to one')
    kernel = -float(alpha) * gaussian.copy()
    kernel[gaussian.shape[0] // 2, gaussian.shape[1] // 2] += 1 + float(alpha)
    return kernel
```

The sharpening kernel is convolved with each RGB channel using “same” output and symmetric boundary extension. All intermediate arrays use float64; clipping is deferred until display export.

E Hybrids and multiresolution stacks

The hybrid combines a low-pass source with a scaled high-pass source. The stack construction keeps every level at the original resolution; the last Gaussian level is retained as the coarse residual.

Hybrid synthesis

```
low = gaussian(A, sigma_low)
high = B − gaussian(B, sigma_high)
hybrid = low + gain ∗ high
```

Stack construction and reconstruction

```
G = [I] + [gaussian(I, 2 ∗ 2 ∗∗ i) for i in range(5)]
L = [G[i] − G[i + 1] for i in range(5)] + [G[−1]]
S = [M[i] ∗ LA[i] + (1 − M[i]) ∗ LB[i] for i in range(6)]
result = sum(S)
```

Numerical representation

Hybrid filtering uses reflected boundaries and signed float64 values. Intermediate bands are neither clipped nor contrast-normalized. Display exports clamp to [0, 1] and quantize to 8 bits; the settings table counts clipped scalar channel values. The signed high-pass display is shifted by 0.5 and includes the synthesis gain, without additional display amplification.

These excerpts show the filtering and reconstruction steps. The source ZIP contains the complete alignment, masking, validation, and figure-generation code.

SUPPORTING INFORMATION

R Reproduction and observations

Observations

Spatial scale determines which structures are preserved. Smoothing suppresses fine variation before differentiation; hybrid images separate broad shape from fine detail; multiresolution blending uses broader transitions for brightness and color than for texture. Numerical agreement checks confirm the implementations, but alignment and source geometry still limit the visual results.

Reproduce the experiments

The source ZIP includes the original inputs, parameters, implementations, tests, measurements, and report builder. The following commands regenerate the experiments and webpage. README.md describes PDF export and image replacement.

```
python3 -m venv .venv
source .venv/bin/activate
python -m pip install -r requirements.txt
python -m unittest discover -s tests -v
python run_filters.py
python run_frequencies.py
python build_report.py
python -m http.server 8000 --directory site
```

Submit the report PDF and code + inputs ZIP together, and include the website URL. Measurements include the comparison diagnostics and level trace; the image manifest records source URLs, rights, dimensions and hashes.

References

1. A. Oliva, A. Torralba, and P. G. Schyns. Hybrid images. ACM Transactions on Graphics 25(3), 527–532, 2006.
2. P. J. Burt and E. H. Adelson. A multiresolution spline with application to image mosaics. ACM Transactions on Graphics 2(4), 217–236, 1983.
3. R. Szeliski. Computer Vision: Algorithms and Applications, second edition. Figure 3.42.
4. SYDE 671 Assignment 2, “Fun with Filters and Frequencies.” The required experiments follow the supplied handout, adapted from Berkeley CS180.

S Image credits

The self portrait and street photograph are the supplied Assignment 1 images. The Taj Mahal, Derek/Nutmeg pair, and original apple and orange PNGs are supplied course samples. The custom examples use the credited source photographs.

Image	Credit	Rights / provenance	Link
Derek portrait	Derek Hoiem / course materials	Course sample; see note below.	Source
Nutmeg the cat	Derek Hoiem / course materials	Course sample; see note below.	Source
Taj Mahal	Course materials; individual photographer not specified	Course sample; see note below.	Source
Classic cameraman	Course materials; individual photographer not specified	Course sample; see note below.	Source
Apple (supplied Burt-Adelson original)	Peter J. Burt and Edward H. Adelson / course materials	Course sample; see note below.	Supplied Part 2 image package
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